Member User Guide

Fraternal Council Archives™

Offline print edition

Compiled 2026-11-02 from docs/MEMBER_USER_GUIDE.md

Fraternal Council Archives™ — Member User Guide

Audience: Brother Knights who volunteer, log service hours, attend meetings, file expenses and take donations.

Covers: the phone app and the member pages of the web portal.

> **Officers and Admins:** read this guide first. Officers volunteer too, so every member task applies to officers. The management pages are in the *Administrator User Guide*.

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2. Get into your account
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8. Propose a charity grant
9. Messages, roster, profile and display
10. Troubleshooting reference
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How to read a task

Each section starts with a **Before you start** box. The box lists who may use the section and what can be lost.

Each task then uses the same parts, in the same order.

Part	What the part tells you
Who can do this	The roles that may do the task. Read this line first.
Warning	A permanent effect, such as lost data or a sent message.
Goal	The result of the task, in one sentence.
Start point	The screen where the task starts.
Steps	One action per step.
Expected result	What you see when the task succeeds.
Common problems	Symptoms, causes and fixes.

1. About the platform

Before you start

- **Access:** every member on the council roster.
- **Data loss:** none. This section explains the platform. It contains no tasks.

1.1 Two ways in, one account

The platform has two parts.

- The **phone app** is for work at an event. Use the phone app to sign up, log hours, follow agendas and take donations.
- The **web portal** opens in a web browser. Use the web portal for long forms, history tables and council records.

One email address and one password open both parts. You create the password in the phone app.

1.2 Who adds you

A member cannot register alone. A council Admin adds each member to the roster. The Admin uses the email address that the council has on file for you. That email address is your sign-in name.

1.3 Phone tabs

The phone app has five tabs at the bottom of the screen. A gold bar marks the open tab.

Tab	Use the tab to
Home	See your upcoming shifts first. Under them: the prayer and devotion drawers and your expense report summary.
Mtgs	Answer meeting invitations and read meeting agendas.
Signup	Find shifts in the next 30 days and sign up.
Report	Log hours for a council activity or for a shift.
Collect	Record cash, card, QR-code and item donations.

The navy header at the top of the phone has two more controls.

- The **envelope** opens **Messages**. A gold number shows your unread messages.
- **Your name** opens **Settings**. **Settings** holds the large text switch and **Sign out**.

Council modules: your council can switch off some modules. A switched-off module has no tab and no menu link.

The **Mtgs**, **Signup** and **Collect** tabs can be switched off. The **Home** and **Report** tabs always show.

1.4 Web portal sidebar

Each block below is collapsible. Only the overview is open. Select a title to open it.

🔎 Overview — read this first

- Every time you sign in, the portal opens on **Home**: the newsletters, the feast days, your reminders, today's agenda, the Top 5 volunteers and the prayer list. Tap **[🙏 Praying Hands]** on the prayer list to pray for an intention. When more cards are below the first screen, the line **Scroll down for more council info** ↓ shows at the bottom. The line fades away when you start to scroll down.

- Your volunteer check-in is on the **Member Actions Hub**. Select **Member Actions Hub** in the sidebar to open it. The page has four tabs: **My active shifts**, **Registration desk**, **Fraternal roster** and **Hour ledger**. Your shift trackers, charity requests and sheets are on the **Member Desk** tab.
- **[Council Roster]** is the first link in the **Faith In Action** pillar. It lists the phone and email of active brothers of your council and its sister councils.
- **Navigation Guide** shows a short summary of each page that you can open.
- The sidebar on the left has seven groups, called pillars. The sidebar shows only the pages that you can open.
- **Navigation Guide** at the top of the sidebar explains each of your links.
- **Media & Memory Center** sits under **Navigation Guide**, above the pillars. Its two links open **Browse Gallery** and the **Gallery Administration Hub**.
- The sidebar shows its links as plain text, with no icons.
- The sidebar has no **Home** link. Select the **Home** tab in the tab row above every page to go back to **Home**.
- Select the menu button (three lines) at the top of the sidebar to hide the sidebar. Select the menu button again to show the sidebar. The portal remembers your choice on this computer.
- If the platform owner invites you to the **Application Advisory Panel**, an invitation card shows at the top of **Home**, on your alert bell and on your phone's **Home**. Select **Accept** to join.
- **Terms of Service** and **Privacy Policy** are at the foot of the sidebar. When the sidebar is hidden, select ⚖ to read them. Both are dated October 26, 2026.
- If a Super Admin made you an **Application Advisory Panelist**, **Application Advisory Panel** shows under **Navigation Guide**.

Dashboard

Link	Pillar	What it holds
Home tab (tab row above every page)	None	The newsletters, the feast days, your reminders, today's agenda, the Top 5 volunteers and the prayer list with **[Praying Hands]**
Member Actions Hub	Faith In Action	Its own page: your active shifts, sign-ups, the roster and your hours
Council Dashboard	Performance	Your impact and the council's engagement

Calendars and meetings

Link	Pillar	What it holds
Visual Master Calendar	Faith In Action	Events, shifts and meetings by date
Meeting Center	Governance	Meetings, invitations and minutes

Rosters and offices

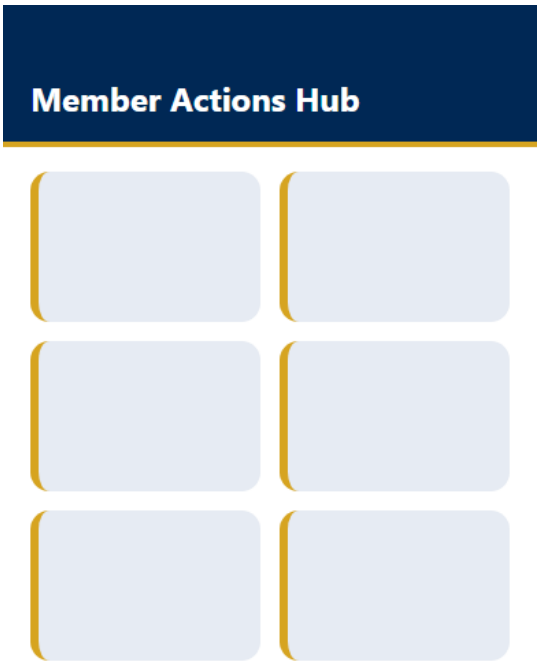
Link	Pillar	What it holds
[Council Roster]	Faith In Action (first link)	The phone, email and degree of active brothers of your council and its sister councils. The same list is on the **Member Desk** tab
Member Actions Hub → Fraternal roster tab	Faith In Action	The same list as **[Council Roster]**
Council Election Center	Governance	Election progress, nominations and the secret ballot at a live meeting

Ledgers and money

Link	Pillar	What it holds
Member Actions Hub → Hour ledger tab	Faith In Action	Your logged service hours
My Expense Reports	Finances	Your expense reports and their status
Propose Charity Grant	Finances	The charity proposal form
Annual Budget Center	Finances	The council's annual budget
Post-event Ledger	Performance	Event results (event owners record them here)

Archives and answers

Link	Pillar	What it holds
Media & Memory Center → Browse Gallery	Top of the sidebar	Photos on three tabs: **Event/Meeting**, **Year** and **Album Picker**, with slideshows
Media & Memory Center → Gallery Administration Hub	Top of the sidebar	Photo uploads, **Pick Selections for Album** and **Save as Album**
Council Artifacts	Resources	Flyers, minutes and photo albums
Constitutional Bylaws	Governance	The council's bylaws
Online Help Center	Answers	Answers to common questions
SOP Center	Answers	The standard operating procedures



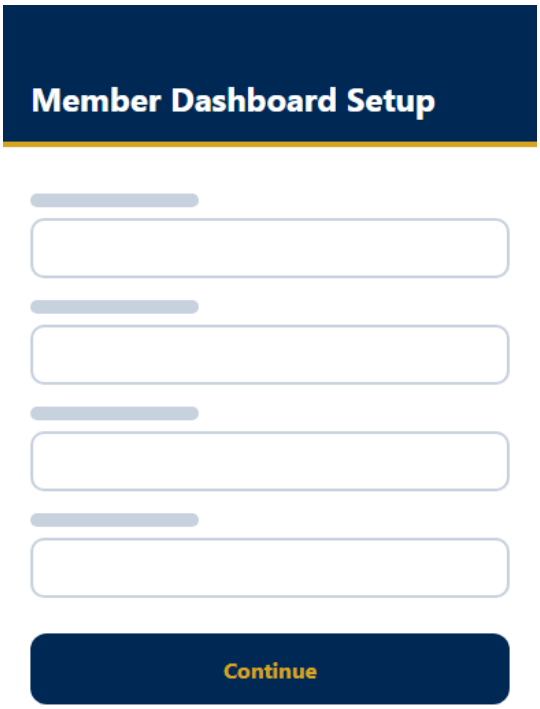
PLACEHOLDER · member_actions_hub.png

Volunteer Check-In & Service Center on the Member Actions Hub (placeholder)

The sidebar shows only the pages that your role can open. Officer desks that your role cannot open do not show.

The header at the top right of the portal has four controls.

- **Messaging** (envelope icon) opens **Council Messages & Alerts** and **My Distribution Lists**.
- **Help** (question-mark icon) opens the **Online Help Center**.
- The **bell** shows the alerts that council leadership sent in the last 6 months.
- **Your name and photo** opens the member menu. The member menu holds **My Profile** and **Sign out**.



PLACEHOLDER · member_dashboard_setup.png

Member Dashboard Setup (placeholder)

1.5 The Navigation Guide

The **Navigation Guide** explains each link in your sidebar. Use it when you cannot find a page.

- **Where:** select **Navigation Guide** at the top of the sidebar, above the pillars.
- **What you see:** one short sentence for each page and desk that you can open. Officers see more: the sidebar pillar of each link and every drawer of their desks. You see only the pages that your role can open.
- **How it opens:** all of the category groups are closed. Only **Overview** is open. Select a group title, for example **Calendars**, to open it. Select the title again to close it.
- **The order:** the overview, then the sidebar categories, then **Your desks**, **Your time limits** and **Phone app tabs**.

To find a page:

1. Select **Navigation Guide** in the sidebar.
2. Select the group title that matches your task.
3. Read the sentence under each link.
4. Select the link name. The page opens.

2. Get into your account

> **Before you start**
>
> - **Access:** a member whom a council Admin added to the roster. Nobody can register without the Admin.
> - **Data loss:** the setup code works one time only. A reset code expires after 15 minutes.

Concept: the setup code

Your welcome email contains a one-time setup code. The code has 20 characters in four groups, like `xxxxx-xxxxx-xxxxx-xxxxx`. The phone app asks for the setup code when you create your password. The code expires 14 days after the email is sent. A used code does not work a second time.

2.1 Install the phone app

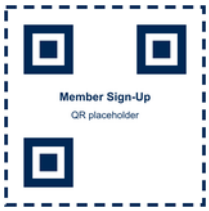
> **Who can do this:** any member on the council roster.

Goal: Open the KofC Tracker phone app on your phone.

Start point: Your welcome email, or the printed codes below.

Steps:

1. Open your welcome email.
2. Follow the Expo Go download steps in the email.
3. Point your phone camera at the **Mobile App (Expo Go)** code below.
4. Tap the link that the camera shows.

Mobile App (Expo Go)	Member Sign-Up
	
Open the KofC Tracker phone app in Expo Go.	Ask to join the council.

Expected result: The phone app opens on the screen **Welcome. What is your email address?**

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The camera does not react to the code.	The code is too far away or too small.	Hold the phone 15 to 30 cm from the code.
You did not get a welcome email.	The Admin has not added you, or the email went to spam.	Check your spam folder. Then call your council Admin.

2.2 Create your password on the phone

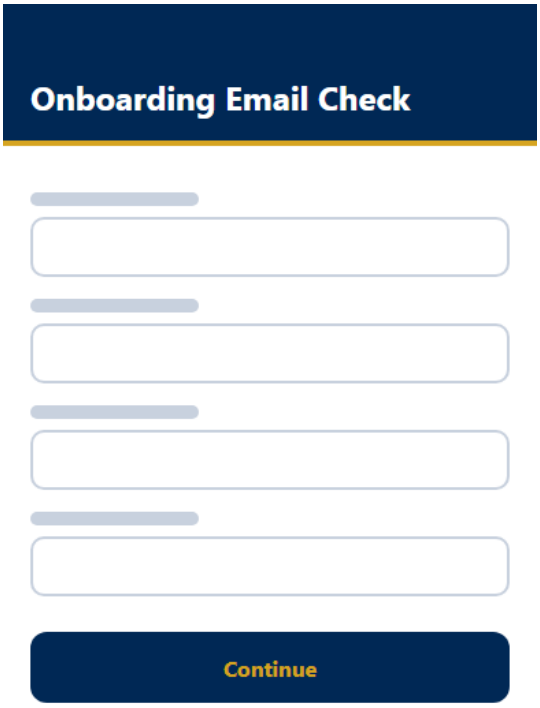
> **Who can do this:** a member on the roster who has no password yet.
>
> **Warning:** the setup code works one time only. Keep the welcome email until you finish.

Goal: Create the password that opens the phone app and the web portal.

Start point: Phone app → **Welcome. What is your email address?**

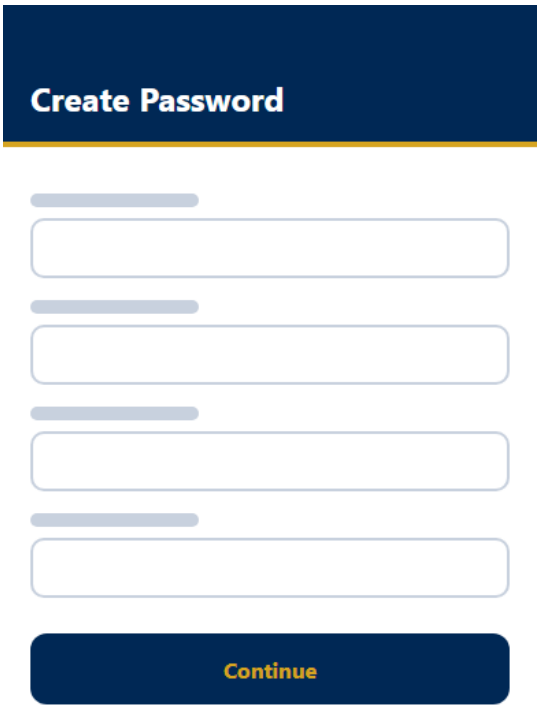
Steps:

1. Enter your email address in **EMAIL**.
2. Tap **Continue**. The screen **Welcome, *your name*. Choose a password.** opens.
3. Enter the code from your welcome email in **SETUP CODE FROM YOUR WELCOME EMAIL**.
4. Enter a password of at least 8 characters in **PASSWORD**.
5. Enter the same password in **CONFIRM PASSWORD**.
6. Tap the eye icon to check what you typed.
7. Tap **Create password**. The app uses the setup code now. You cannot use the code again.



PLACEHOLDER · onboarding_email_check.png

Onboarding Email Check (placeholder)



PLACEHOLDER · create_password_screen.png

Create Password Screen (placeholder)

Expected result: The **Home** tab opens. The phone keeps you signed in until you sign out. The phone also turns on biometric sign-in for your account (see 2.4).

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
"We could not find … in the member roster." and a **Contact your council admin** card	Your email is not on the roster, or the email has a typo.	Tap **Try a different email**. If the email is correct, call the Admin on the card.
"That setup code is not valid for this email, has already been used, or has expired."	The code is wrong, used or older than 14 days.	Ask your council Admin to send a new setup code.
"The two passwords do not match."	**CONFIRM PASSWORD** differs from **PASSWORD**.	Type both passwords again.
The app refuses the password.	The password has fewer than 8 characters.	Choose a longer password.
The screen shows **Welcome back**.	You created a password before.	Sign in with your password (2.3).

2.3 Sign in on the phone with a password

> **Who can do this:** any member with a password.

Goal: Open the phone app after you signed out.

Start point: Phone app → **Welcome. What is your email address?**

Steps:

1. Enter your email address in **EMAIL**.
2. Tap **Continue**. The **Welcome back** screen opens.
3. Enter your password in **PASSWORD**.
4. Tap **Sign in**.

Expected result: The **Home** tab opens.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
"Incorrect password. Please try again."	The password is wrong.	Type the password again. If you forgot the password, reset the password (2.6).

2.4 Sign in on the phone with Face ID or a fingerprint

> **Who can do this:** a member who created the password on this phone with a setup code.

Goal: Sign in without typing your password.

Start point: Phone app → the email screen or the **Welcome back** screen.

Steps:

1. Tap **Sign In with FaceID / Biometrics**.
2. Look at the phone, or touch the fingerprint sensor.

Expected result: The **Home** tab opens.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The biometric button does not show.	You created your password on another phone, or before biometric sign-in existed.	Sign in with your password, with the **[◉ Enable FaceID / Biometric Login]** switch on (2.4.1).
"The biometric check did not pass."	The phone did not recognize your face or finger.	Try again, or sign in with your password.
"Face ID or fingerprint is not available on this phone right now."	The phone has no enrolled face or finger.	Sign in with your password.
"Your council has turned off biometric sign-in."	Your council's leaders turned off biometric sign-in. The phone deletes its biometric key.	Sign in with your password.

2.4.1 Turn on Face ID sign-in from the password screen

> **Who can do this:** a member who has a password, on a phone with Face ID or a fingerprint enrolled.

Goal: Turn on Face ID or fingerprint sign-in on this phone.

Start point: Phone app → the **Welcome back** screen.

Steps:

1. Type your password.
2. Tap the **[◉ Enable FaceID / Biometric Login]** switch. The switch turns dark.
3. Tap **Sign in**.
4. Look at the phone, or touch the fingerprint sensor.

Expected result: The **Home** tab opens. The next time, the sign-in screen shows **Sign In with FaceID / Biometrics** (2.4).

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The switch does not show.	The phone has no enrolled face or finger, or biometric sign-in is already on for you.	Enroll a face or finger in the phone settings. Or use the biometric button (2.4).
You signed in, but the biometric button does not show the next time.	The scan did not pass, or you tapped **Use password**.	Sign in with your password again, with the switch on.
You signed in with the switch on, but no scan came.	Your council turned off biometric sign-in.	Sign in with your password.

2.5 Sign in to the web portal

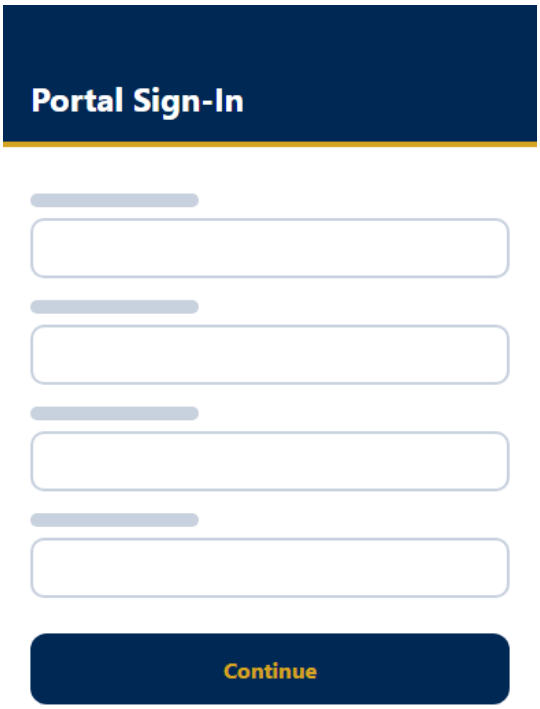
> **Who can do this:** any member with a password.

Goal: Open the web portal in a web browser.

Start point: The portal address that your council gave you.

Steps:

1. Enter your email address in **Email**.
2. Enter your password in **Password**.
3. Select **Sign in**.



PLACEHOLDER · portal_sign_in.png

Portal Sign-In (placeholder)

Expected result: The portal opens with the sidebar on the left.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
"That email and password do not match a registered member."	The email or the password is wrong.	Check both fields.
You never created a password.	You create the password in the phone app only.	Do task 2.2 on your phone first.

2.5.1 Sign in to the web portal with Face ID or a fingerprint

> **Who can do this:** any member whose council allows biometric sign-in, on a computer or tablet with Face ID, Touch ID or Windows Hello.

Goal: Sign in to the web portal without typing your password.

Start point: My Profile (header member menu) → **Two-Factor Authentication** card → **WebAuthn biometric hardware passkeys** row, once; then the portal's sign-in page.

Steps:

1. Sign in with your password (2.5). Open **My Profile**.
2. Select 🔐 **Set up FaceID sign-in**. Look at the camera or touch the sensor when the computer asks.
3. Next time, select 🔐 **Sign in with FaceID** on the sign-in page. Look at the camera or touch the sensor.

Expected result: The portal opens with the sidebar on the left. Your password is not asked.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The sign-in page has no **Sign in with FaceID** button.	The browser cannot use Face ID or fingerprint sign-in.	Use a current browser, or sign in with your password.
"FaceID sign-in is no longer set up for this account."	Your login changed, or your council switched biometric sign-in off.	Sign in with your password. Set FaceID up again on **My Profile**.
"Your council has switched biometric sign-in off."	The council turned off biometric sign-in.	Sign in with your password.

2.5.2 Concept: the Two-Factor Authentication card

The **Two-Factor Authentication** card on **My Profile** has one row for each second step after your password.

Row	What it is	Status
SMS text tokens	A 6-digit code sent by text message to your cell phone.	**Set up** when the portal has a text provider and you must type a code. **Not connected yet** when the portal has no text provider.
Email secure passcodes	A one-time passcode sent to your email address.	**Set up** when the portal has an email provider and you must type a code. **Not connected yet** when it has none.
WebAuthn biometric hardware passkeys	Your device's face or fingerprint check unlocks a passkey.	Works on Android (Chrome), iOS and iPadOS (Safari) and desktop browsers (2.5.1).

A row that says **Add contact details first** needs a phone number or email address under **Contact details**.

Who types a code: Admins and Super Admins always type a code when the portal has a provider. When your council turns on sign-in codes for every member, you type a code too (2.5.3). A Face ID, fingerprint or passkey sign-in never asks for a code.

2.5.3 Type a sign-in code

> **Who can do this:** any member who must type a sign-in code (2.5.2).
>
> **Warning:** the code expires after 5 minutes. After 5 wrong codes, you must sign in again for a new code.

Goal: Finish the sign-in with the 6-digit code that the portal sends you.

Start point: The web sign-in page, or the phone app's **Welcome back** screen, after you type your password.

Steps:

1. Type your email and password. Select **Sign in**. The **Enter your sign-in code** screen opens. It shows where the code went, for example **--**0142.
2. On a phone, wait for the text message. The code shows above the keyboard. Tap the code once to fill the box. On a computer, type the 6 digits from the text or the email.
3. Select **Verify and sign in**.

Expected result: The portal opens on **Home**. On the phone, the app opens.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The code does not show above the keyboard.	The text has not come yet, or the phone keyboard does not offer codes.	Wait a few seconds. Open the text message and type the 6 digits.
"That code is not correct. 4 tries left."	A digit is wrong.	Type the code again.
"The code has expired. Sign in again for a new one."	More than 5 minutes passed.	Select **Start over**. Sign in again.
"Ask your council admin to add your cell phone."	No cell phone or email on file can receive a code.	Ask your council admin to add your cell phone to the roster.

2.6 Reset a forgotten password

> **Who can do this:** any member with a password.
>
> **Warning:** the reset code expires after 15 minutes. The code stops working after 5 wrong tries.

Goal: Choose a new password without help from an Admin.

Start point: Phone app → **Forgot Password?** link. Web portal → **Forgot Password?** link on the sign-in panel.

Steps:

1. Select **Forgot Password?**.
2. Enter the email address that you sign in with.
3. Select **Email me a reset code**.
4. Open the email. Find the 6-digit code.
5. Enter the code in **6-DIGIT RESET CODE** (phone) or **6-digit reset code** (web).
6. Select **Continue**.
7. Enter a new password of at least 8 characters, two times.
8. Select **Save new password** (phone) or **Save new password and sign in** (web).

Expected result: You are signed in with the new password.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
No email arrives.	The email address is not on the roster. The screen gives the same answer for every address.	Check the address. Then ask your council Admin.
A second request does nothing.	The platform ignores a new request within 60 seconds.	Wait 60 seconds. Then request again.
The code is refused.	The code expired, or a newer request replaced the code.	Request a new code. Use only the newest code.

2.7 Sign out

> **Who can do this:** any signed-in member.

Goal: Close your session on a phone or a browser.

Start point: Phone app → your name in the header → **Settings**. Web portal → your name at the top right.

Steps:

1. Phone: open **Settings**. Tap **Sign out** under **Account**.
2. Web: select your name. Select **Sign out**.

Expected result: The sign-in screen opens. The phone keeps the biometric key, so biometric sign-in still works next time.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The header shows no **Sign out** button.	Large Text Layout Mode hides the header text.	Tap ⚙ **Settings**. Then tap **Sign out**.

3. Sign up for shifts

Before you start

- **Access:** any active member. The pages show only when your council keeps the **Event shifts** module on.
- **Data loss:** none. The phone app has no button to leave a shift. Tell the event owner if you cannot work.

Concept: shifts, tags and the sign-up window

An event has one or more shifts. A shift has a date, a time and a minimum number of volunteers. The phone **Signup** tab lists shifts in the next 30 days. The web **Registration desk** lists shifts in the next 6 months. Both lists show your council and its sister councils.

Tag	Meaning
NEEDS *n* MORE	The shift still needs *n* volunteers.
Priority (gold)	Nobody has signed up yet, or the shift starts within 7 days.
WITHIN 2 DAYS (red)	The shift starts within 48 hours.
FULL	The shift has its minimum volunteers.
YOU'RE SIGNED UP	You are on the shift.

A full shift still takes extra volunteers. An extra volunteer is an honorary volunteer.

3.1 Sign up for a shift on the phone

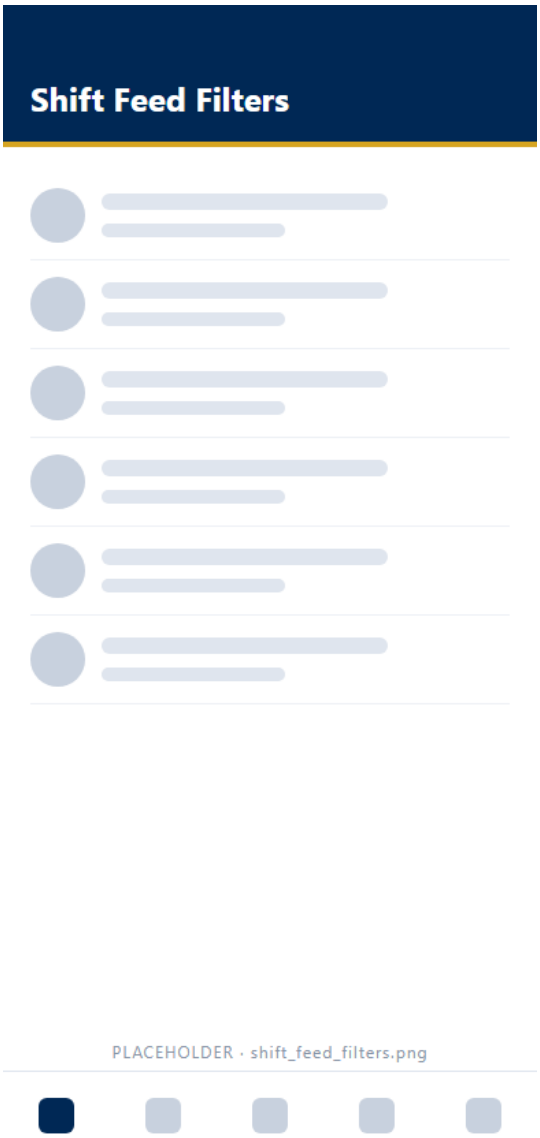
Who can do this: any active member.

Goal: Put your name on a shift.

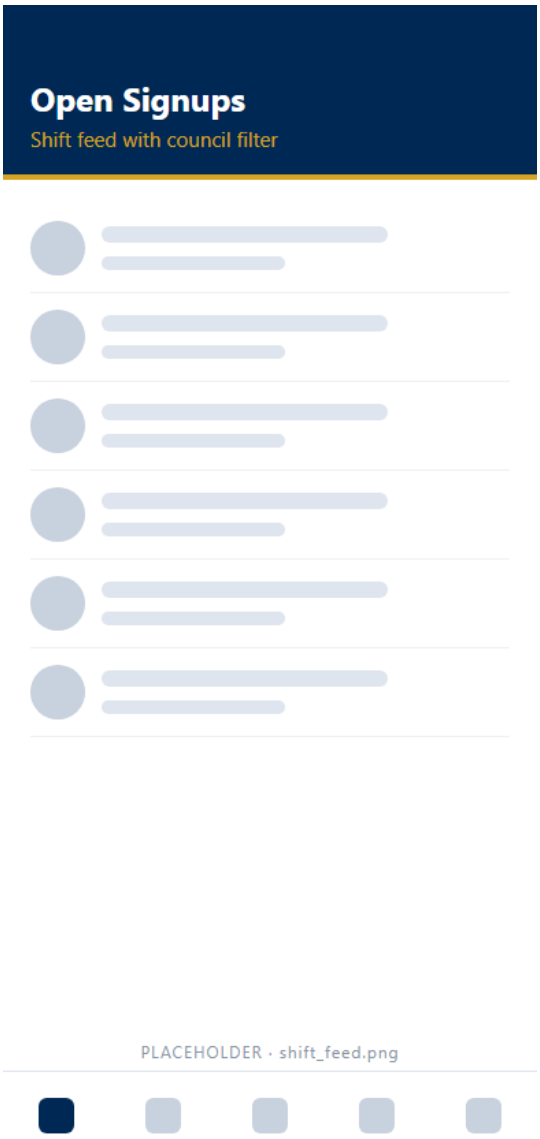
Start point: Phone app → **Signup** tab.

Steps:

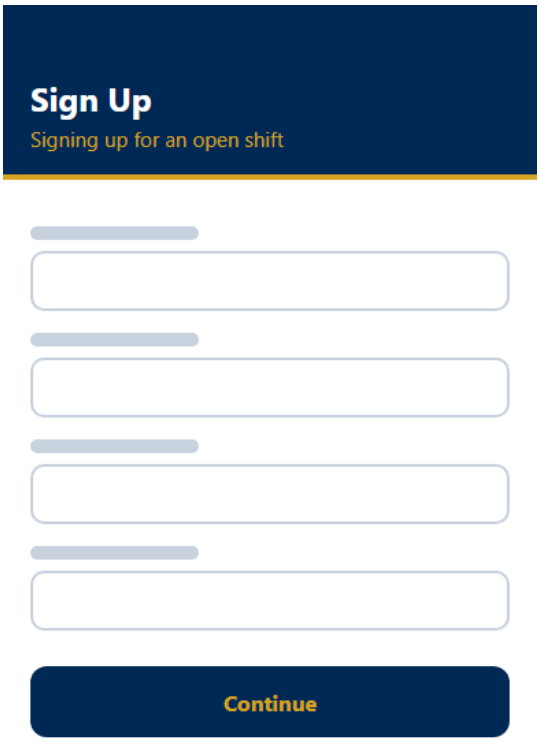
1. Open the **Shifts Opening** sub-tab. Use the **Full Up** sub-tab for full shifts.
2. Optional: choose a council in the **Council** filter.
3. Find the shift.
4. Tap **Sign up**. On a full shift, tap **Sign up as honorary volunteer**.



Shift Feed Filters (placeholder)



Phone: open signups shift feed with council filter (placeholder)



Phone: signing up for an open shift (placeholder)

Expected result: The shift card shows **YOU'RE SIGNED UP**. The shift also shows under **My Active Shifts** on the **Home** tab.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The **Signup** tab is missing.	Your council switched off the **Event shifts** module.	Ask your council Admin.
"No shift in the next 30 days for this filter is full yet."	No full shift matches the filter on **Full Up**.	Change the **Council** filter, or use **Shifts Opening**.
The shift is not in the list.	The shift is more than 30 days away.	Use the web **Registration desk** (3.2).

3.2 Register for a shift in the web portal

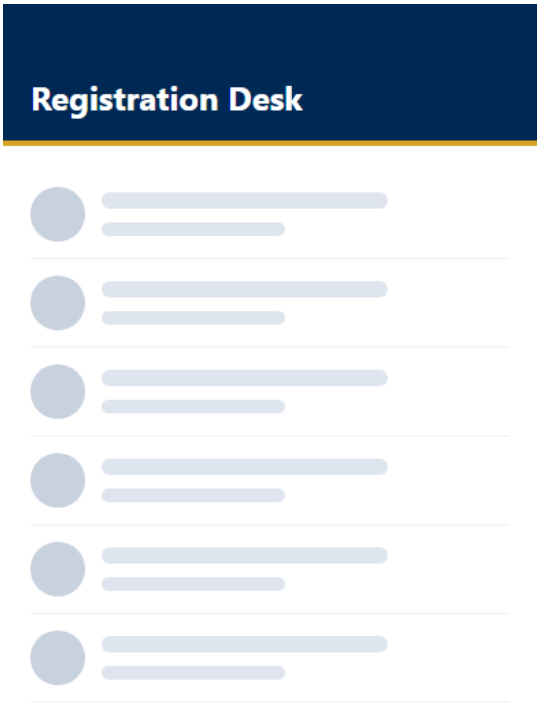
> **Who can do this:** any active member.

Goal: Put your name on a shift that still needs volunteers.

Start point: Sidebar → Faith In Action → **Member Actions Hub** → **Registration desk** tab.

Steps:

1. Optional: choose a council in **Council**. The default is **All: my council and sister councils**.
2. Find the shift in the table.
3. Select **Register**.



PLACEHOLDER · registration_desk.png

Registration Desk (placeholder)

Expected result: The **Register** button changes to a **Registered** pill.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
"Every shift in range has its volunteers."	The desk lists only shifts that need volunteers.	Use the phone **Full Up** sub-tab to join a full shift.

3.3 Check your upcoming shifts

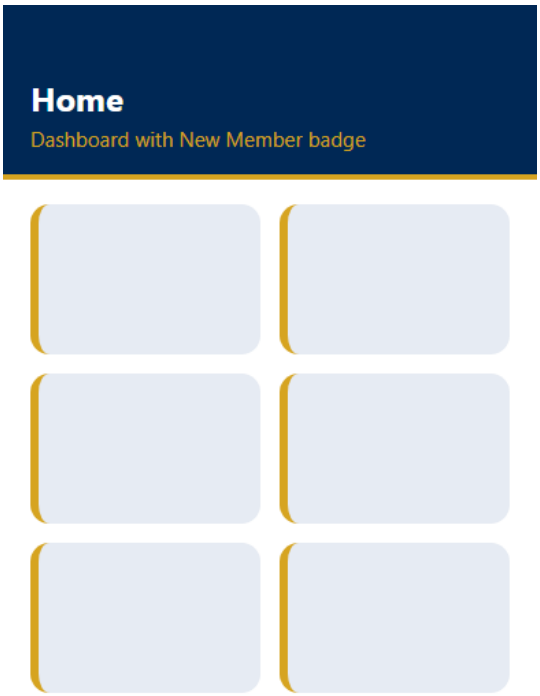
> **Who can do this:** any member.

Goal: See the shifts that you signed up for.

Start point: Phone app → **Home** → **My Active Shifts**. Web portal → Sidebar → Faith In Action → **Member Actions Hub** → **My active shifts**.

Steps:

1. Open the start point.
2. Read the date, the time and the location of each shift.



PLACEHOLDER · home_dashboard_with_badge.png

Home Dashboard With Badge (placeholder)



PLACEHOLDER · report_absence.png

Report Absence (placeholder)

Expected result: My Active Shifts is the first section on the phone **Home** tab. A shift within 48 hours shows in red. The phone shows **WITHIN 2 DAYS**. The web shows **Within 48 hours**. Other shifts show **Scheduled** on the web.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
A shift left **My Active Shifts**.	The phone hides a shift when the shift ends. The phone also hides a shift marked as a no-show.	Check **My shift history** in the web **Hour ledger**.
You cannot work a shift.	The phone app has no absence button.	Tell the event owner. The event owner finds a replacement.

Concept: your personal calendar link

The web portal gives each member a personal calendar link. A calendar app uses the link to show your schedule. The link works with Google Calendar, Apple Calendar and Outlook.

The calendar shows only your own schedule:

- the shifts that you signed up for, with the event name and the event location;
- the council meetings that you are invited to. A meeting that you declined does not show.

The calendar starts 30 days before today. Your calendar app checks the link for changes about once an hour. The calendar reads the council's saved records. Your shifts from the last 30 days stay in the calendar after the portal restarts. The calendar is read-only. Sign up for shifts and answer invitations in the portal or the phone app.

The link is private. A person who has your link can read your schedule. Do not share the link.

3.4 Sync your schedule with your phone calendar

> **Who can do this:** any member.

Goal: See your shifts and meetings in Google Calendar, Apple Calendar or Outlook.

Start point: Web portal → Sidebar → Faith In Action → **Visual Master Calendar** → 🗓 **Sync with Your Phone Calendar** card, below the calendar.

Steps:

1. Open the start point.
2. Read your link in the **Your personal calendar link** box.
3. Select **Copy link**.
4. Add the link to your calendar app:

Calendar app	What to do
Google Calendar	On a computer, open Google Calendar. Select **+** next to **Other calendars**. Select **From URL**. Paste the link. Select **Add calendar**.
iPhone or iPad	Open **Settings** → **Apps** → **Calendar** → **Calendar Accounts** → **Add Account** → **Other** → **Add Subscribed Calendar**. Paste the link. Tap **Next**.
Outlook	Select **Add calendar** → **Subscribe from web**. Paste the link. Select **Import**.

5. On an iPhone, an iPad or a computer with Outlook, you can select **Subscribe** on the card instead of steps 3 and 4.

Expected result: A calendar named **Knights of Columbus - My Schedule** shows in your calendar app. Each shift shows as "event name - shift name". Each meeting shows with its name and location.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The card says *"Sign in again: there is no portal session on the server."*	Your portal sign-in ended.	Sign out. Sign in to the web portal again.
A new shift is not in your calendar app.	The calendar app checks the link about once an hour. Google Calendar can take up to 24 hours.	Wait. Or refresh the calendar in the app.
The calendar app says that it cannot open the link.	The calendar app cannot reach the council's portal from the internet.	Ask a council Admin for the public address of the portal.
The app shows *"This calendar link is not valid."*	The council changed its portal key. Old links stop working.	Copy a new link from the card. Replace the old link in the app.
Someone else has your link.	The link is a private key to your schedule. One link cannot be stopped alone.	Tell a council Admin. Only a new portal key stops the link. The new key also stops the links of all other members.

4. Log your hours with the Rapid-Tap grid

Before you start

- **Access:** any active member logs activity time. Only a member who signed up for a shift logs time on that shift.
- **Data loss:** a confirmed tap saves 15 minutes at once. **Clear** throws away queued taps.
- **Data loss:** queued taps live on this phone only. Close the app before you slide, and the queued taps are lost.
- **Data loss:** a new save on a shift replaces the earlier hours for that shift.

Concept: the 15-minute rule

The platform records time in 15-minute steps. One step is 0.25 hours.

You log	The platform saves
15 min	0.25
1 h 15 min	1.25
2 h 45 min	2.75

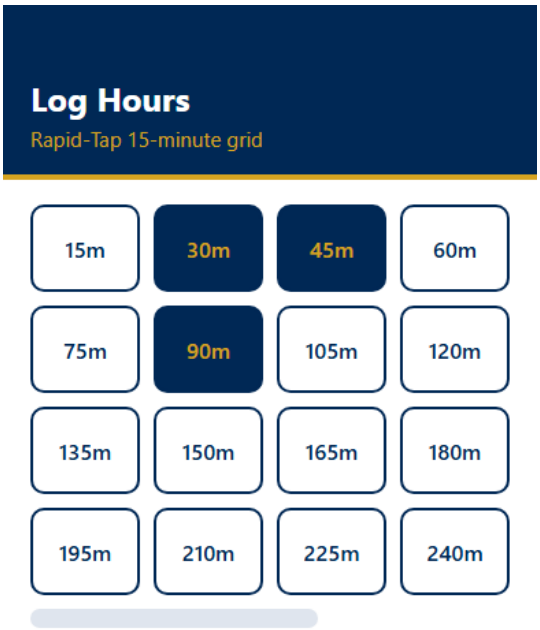
- One entry is more than 0 hours and no more than 24 hours.
- You may log more time than the planned shift length.
- The platform refuses any other value, such as 1.33 hours.

Concept: the Rapid-Tap grid

The **Report** tab opens on the **Activities** sub-tab. The sub-tab shows a grid of large navy tiles. Each tile is one council activity, such as Parish Maintenance. One tap on a tile is 15 minutes of today's time.

Each tile shows a gold status line.

Status line	Meaning
+15 MIN	You logged no time on the activity today.
***n* H *n* M TODAY**	The time that the platform saved for you today.
+*n* M QUEUED	Taps that wait for the slide bar. The platform has not saved the taps yet.



PLACEHOLDER · log_hours_grid.png

Phone: Rapid-Tap grid of navy 15-minute activity tiles (placeholder)

Concept: the slide bar

A phone in a pocket can touch the screen by accident. The slide bar stops an accidental touch from logging time.

- A tap on a tile does not save time. The tap goes into a queue.
- The platform saves the queue only when you drag **Slide to Log Hours** to the right end of the bar.
- A touch in a pocket cannot drag the bar to the end. The bar springs back and saves nothing.

The phone does not ask for Face ID, a fingerprint or a passcode when you tap a tile. Your sign-in unlocks the whole app. You prove who you are one time, when you sign in (2.4).

The muted line under **Tap an activity: 15 minutes per tap** reads: *"Taps wait in a queue. When you are done, drag the Slide to Log Hours bar at the bottom to save them."*

Concept: time windows

You log	Window
A council activity on the web	Dates up to 90 days before today

You log	Window
A council activity on the phone	Today only
A shift on the web	Shifts up to 90 days before today
A shift on the phone	From the event start to 30 days after the event ends, inside the 90-day window

The numbers in the table are the defaults. Your council can change the 90 days and the 30 days. The **Navigation Guide** shows your council's numbers under **Your time limits**.

After a window closes, the platform locks the entry. The lock protects the council's records.

Concept: reminders

You get a text reminder when you signed up for a shift and logged no hours.

- The first reminder goes out 5 days after the shift.
- A new reminder goes out every 7 days.
- Reminders stop when the shift is more than 90 days old.

The numbers are the defaults. Your council can change them. The **Navigation Guide** shows your council's numbers.

4.1 Queue activity taps

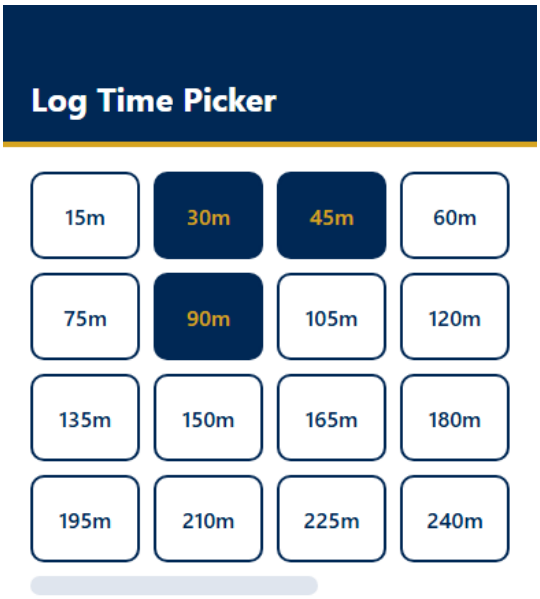
> **Who can do this:** any active member who is signed in on the phone.
>
> **Warning:** queued taps are not saved until you slide. Do not close the app with taps in the queue.

Goal: Add today's time on a council activity to the queue, 15 minutes per tap.

Start point: Phone app → **Report** tab → **Activities** sub-tab.

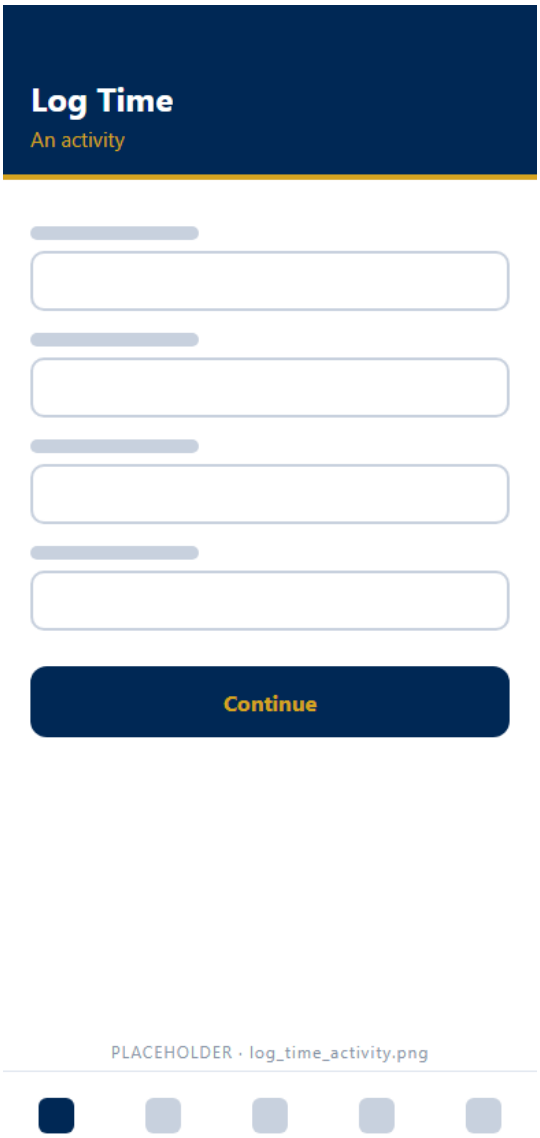
Steps:

1. Find the activity tile under **Tap an activity: 15 minutes per tap**.
2. Count your time in 15-minute steps. For example, 1 hour is 4 taps.
3. Tap the tile one time for each 15 minutes.
4. Read the message *"Queued +15 min · activity name. Slide below to log."*
5. Read the tile status line. Check that the queued total is correct.
6. Save the queue with the slide bar (4.2).

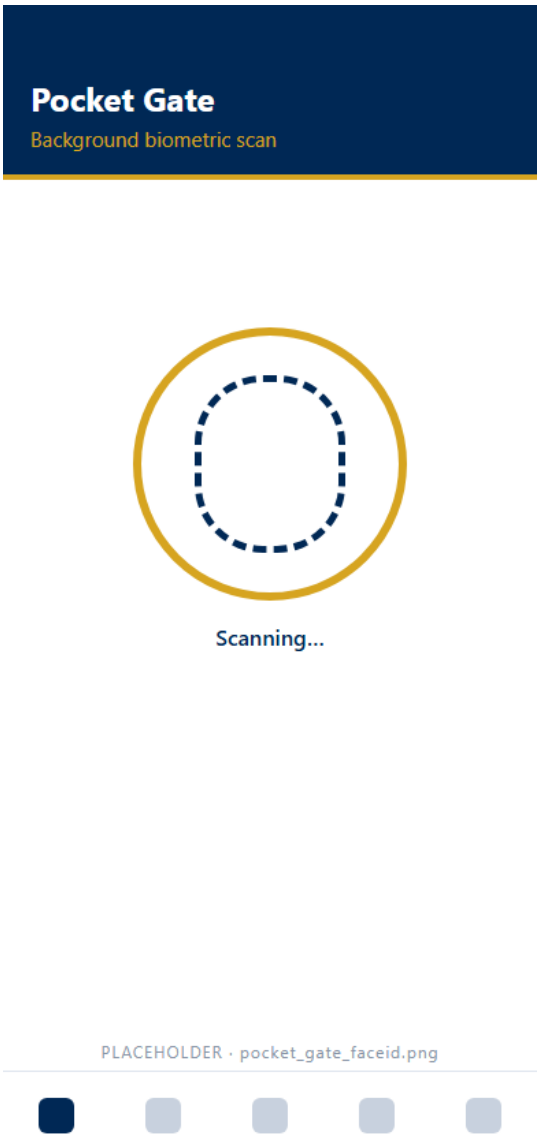


PLACEHOLDER · log_time_picker.png

Log Time Picker (placeholder)



Phone: Log time, an activity (placeholder)



Phone: Face ID prompt, now shown at sign-in only (placeholder)

Expected result: Each tile that you tapped shows a ***+n* M QUEUED** status line. The slide bar opens at the bottom of the screen with the queue total, for example **1 h queued**.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
You tapped too many times.	Each tap adds 15 minutes to the queue.	Tap **Clear** (4.3). Then tap again.
"Your council has no activities yet. An admin can add them."	The council has no activity list.	Ask your council Admin to add activities.
You need to log a past date.	The phone logs today only.	Use the web **Hour ledger** (4.5).

4.2 Save queued taps with the slide bar

Who can do this: any active member with taps in the queue.

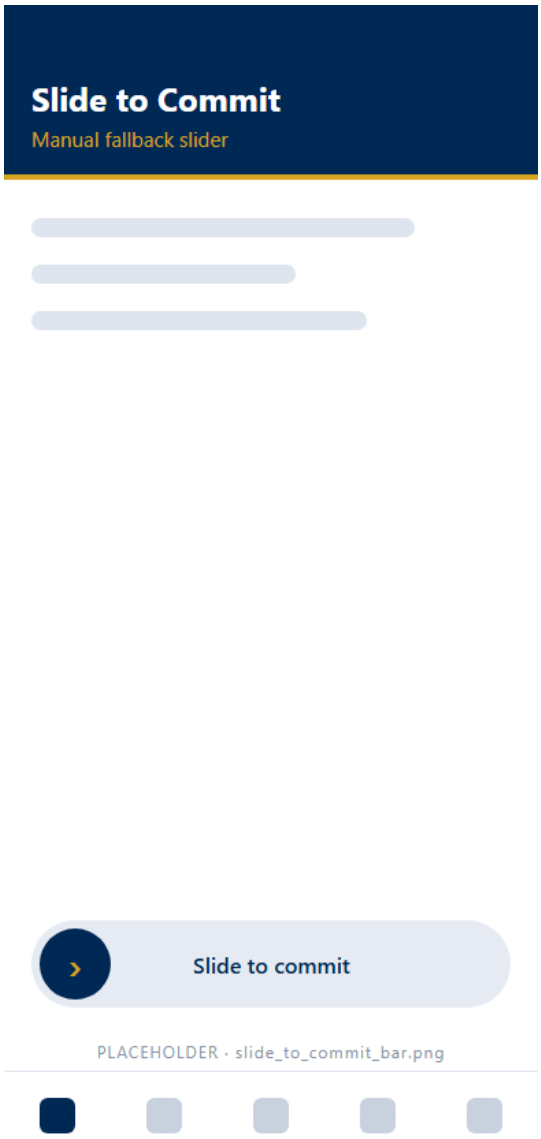
Warning: the slide saves every queued tap at once. Only your council Admin can correct saved time.

Goal: Save a group of queued activity taps in one action.

Start point: Phone app → **Report** tab → **Activities** sub-tab → the slide bar at the bottom.

Steps:

1. Check the queue total above the slide bar, for example **1 h queued**.
2. Put your thumb on the gold circle at the left of **Slide to Log Hours**.
3. Drag the circle to the right end of the bar. Then let go. The platform saves the queue.



Phone: Slide to Log Hours bar with queued total (placeholder)

Expected result: A message shows *"Logged 1 h for today."* The slide bar closes. The tile status line shows the new total for today, for example **1 H 15 M TODAY**.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The circle springs back. Nothing saves.	You let go before the right end of the bar.	Drag the circle all the way to the right end.
The queue stays after a slide.	The platform refused one save. The refused taps stay in the queue.	Read the error message. Then slide again.

Problem	Cause	Fix
The queue total is too high.	You tapped too many times.	Tap **Clear** (4.3). Then tap again.

4.3 Clear queued taps

> **Who can do this:** any active member with taps in the queue.
>
> **Warning: Clear** throws away every queued tap. The platform saved nothing for the cleared taps.

Goal: Remove queued taps that are wrong, before the platform saves them.

Start point: Phone app → **Report** tab → **Activities** sub-tab → the slide bar at the bottom.

Steps:

1. Read the queue total above the slide bar.
2. Tap **Clear**. You cannot undo this.
3. Tap the tiles again for the correct time.

Expected result: The slide bar closes. The **QUEUED** text leaves each tile. Time that you saved earlier today stays saved.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
Saved time is still on the tile.	**Clear** removes queued taps only.	Ask your council Admin to correct saved time.

4.4 Log shift hours on the phone

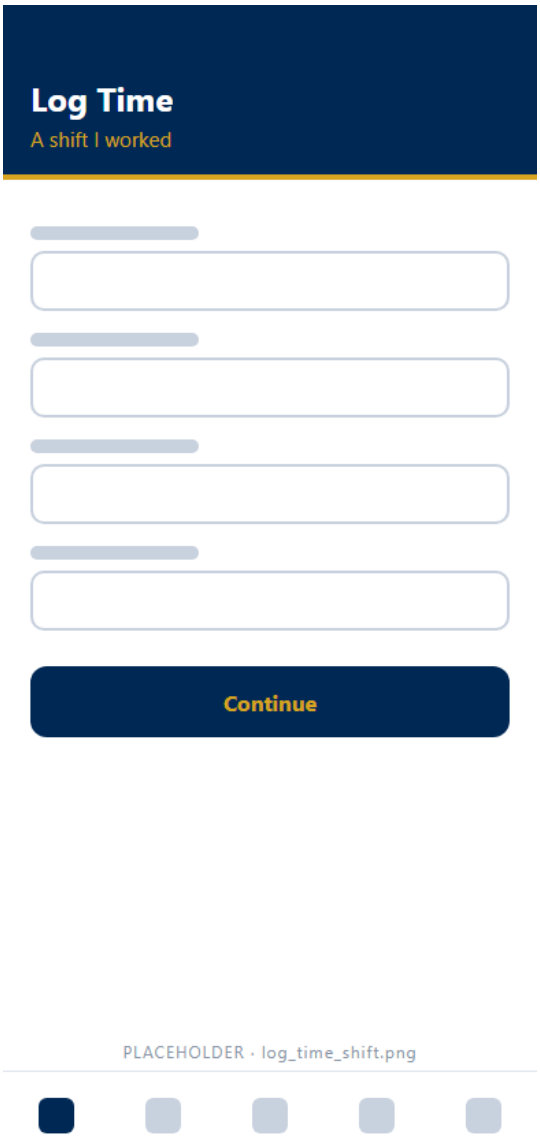
> **Who can do this:** any member who signed up for the shift.
>
> **Warning:** a new save replaces the earlier hours for the same shift.

Goal: Report the time that you worked on a shift.

Start point: Phone app → **Report** tab → **A shift I worked** sub-tab.

Steps:

1. Under **Which shift?**, tap the shift. The app picks your newest shift with **NO TIME LOGGED YET**.
2. Under **How long?**, check the total. The total starts at the planned shift length.
3. Tap **− 15 min** or **+ 15 min** to change the total.
4. Optional: add text in **NOTES (OPTIONAL)**.
5. Tap **Save time**. The new total replaces any earlier total for the shift.



Phone: Log time, a shift I worked (placeholder)

Expected result: A message shows *"Saved 3 h to Morning Setup"*. The shift card shows **LOGGED 3 H · TAP TO CHANGE**.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The button shows 🔒 **Reporting locked**.	The event has not started, or the event ended more than 30 days ago.	Use the web **Hour ledger** within 90 days of the shift.
The **A shift I worked** sub-tab is missing.	Your council switched off the **Event shifts** module.	Log activity time only.
"You have no shifts in the last 90 days to report time for."	You have no shift in the window.	Log activity time instead.

4.5 Log hours in the web portal

> **Who can do this:** any active member.
>
> **Warning:** a new save on the same shift replaces the earlier hours.

Goal: Log shift or activity time from a computer.

Start point: Sidebar → Faith In Action → **Member Actions Hub** → **Hour ledger** tab.

Steps:

1. For a shift: go to **Report time on a shift**. Choose the shift in **Shift I worked**.
2. For an activity: go to **Report time on an activity**. Choose **Council activity** and **Date worked**.
3. Choose **Hours** and **Minutes**. Minutes are :00, :15, :30 or :45.
4. Optional: add text in **Notes (optional)**.
5. Select **Save shift hours** or **Save activity hours**.

Expected result: The time shows in **My shift history** or **My activity history**.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The shift is not in **Shift I worked**.	The shift is older than the logging window (90 days by default).	Ask your council Admin to check the record.
The date is refused.	The date is older than the logging window (90 days by default).	The window is closed. Ask your council Admin.

4.6 Review your hour history

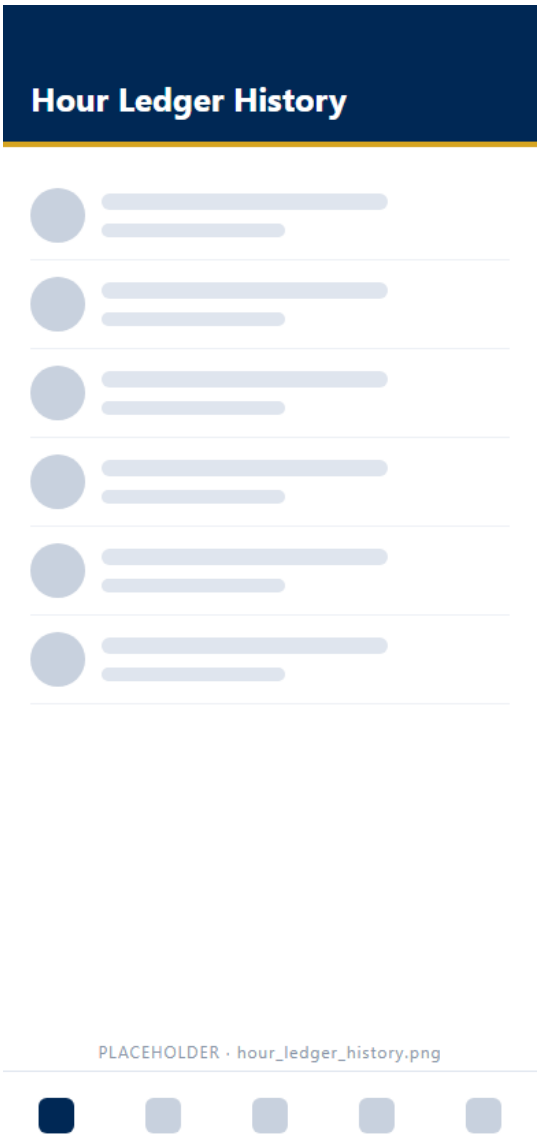
> **Who can do this:** any member, on the member's own history.

Goal: Check which shifts still need hours.

Start point: Sidebar → Faith In Action → **Member Actions Hub** → **Hour ledger** → **My shift history**.

Steps:

1. Read the status of each past shift.
2. Log hours for each shift with **Hours needed** (4.5).



Hour Ledger History (placeholder)

Expected result: Every past shift shows one of four statuses.

Status	Meaning
Logged	The hours are saved.
Hours needed	You worked the shift. You did not log hours yet.
No-show	An Admin marked you absent.
Closed	The logging window (90 days by default) has passed.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
A shift shows **No-show** by mistake.	An Admin marked the no-show.	Ask your council Admin to clear the no-show.

5. Read agendas and follow live meetings

Before you start

- **Access:** any active member reads agendas. Only officers, Admins and the meeting owner change a meeting.
- **Access:** the **Mtgs** tab shows only when your council keeps the **Meeting management** module on.
- **Data loss:** none. The agenda is read only. An invitation answer saves at once, and you can change the answer.

Concept: invitations

Officers schedule council meetings and invite members. Some invitations are released 5 days before the meeting. The number of days can change. An invitation does not show in your list before the release day.

Concept: the full-text agenda

Each meeting has an agenda, called the order of business. The agenda has numbered sections, such as **I.**, **II.** and **III.** Each section has numbered lines. The phone shows the full text of every line.

Each line can show three more items.

- The speaker's name and role, for example *Tom · Grand Knight*.
- A motion result tag: **PENDING**, **PASSED**, **FAILED** or **TABLED**.
- A hand count, for example **Hands 24 – 3**.

Concept: live tracking and the gold highlight

During a live meeting, the Grand Knight (GK) puts one agenda line "on the floor". The line on the floor is the item under discussion now. The phone reads the agenda again every 3 seconds. The phone marks the line on the floor in four ways.

Mark	Where	What the mark shows
● **LIVE** tag (red)	The navy agenda header	The meeting is in progress.
NOW ON THE FLOOR banner (gold)	Under the header	The item name and the time left on the item.
Navy section heading	The section title	The section that holds the line on the floor.
Gold line with a heavy navy frame and an **ON THE FLOOR** tag	The agenda line	The exact line under discussion.

Large Text Layout Mode: the phone does not fill any mark with gold. Each mark is black inside a thick white frame.

5.1 Answer a meeting invitation

Who can do this: any member with an invitation.

Goal: Tell the council that you will attend.

Start point: Phone app → **Mtgs** tab → **My Invites**.

Steps:

1. Find the meeting card.
2. Tap ✋ **Count Me In**.
3. To withdraw your answer, tap ✓ **Attending**.

Expected result: The button changes to a green ✓ **Attending** banner. The app saves the answer at once.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
"You have no meeting invitations."	You have no invitation, or the release day has not come.	Check **All Schedules**.
The button changes back.	The save failed. A message gives the reason.	Read the message. Then tap again.

5.2 Read the full-text agenda before a meeting

> **Who can do this:** any active member of the council.

Goal: Read every agenda line before the meeting starts.

Start point: Phone app → **Mtgs** tab.

Steps:

1. Find the meeting card under **My Invites** or **All Schedules**.
2. Tap **Full agenda**. The **Agenda** sub-tab opens on the meeting.
3. Or: tap the **Agenda** sub-tab. Tap the meeting date and name in the row of buttons at the top.
4. Read the navy header. The header shows the meeting name, the date, the time and the location.
5. Scroll down through the sections and the lines.
6. Read the speaker and the motion tag under each line.

Expected result: The agenda shows every section in order. Each line shows its full text. The **Agenda** sub-tab opens on the live meeting by default. With no live meeting, the sub-tab opens on the next meeting.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
"Nothing listed." under a section	The section has no lines yet.	Check again closer to the meeting.
"Your council has no upcoming meeting with an agenda."	The council has no meeting on the calendar.	Check again later.
A line in the web agenda is not on the phone.	An officer is still writing the line. The phone hides a blank line.	Wait. The phone shows the line when the officer adds text.

5.3 Follow a live agenda on the phone

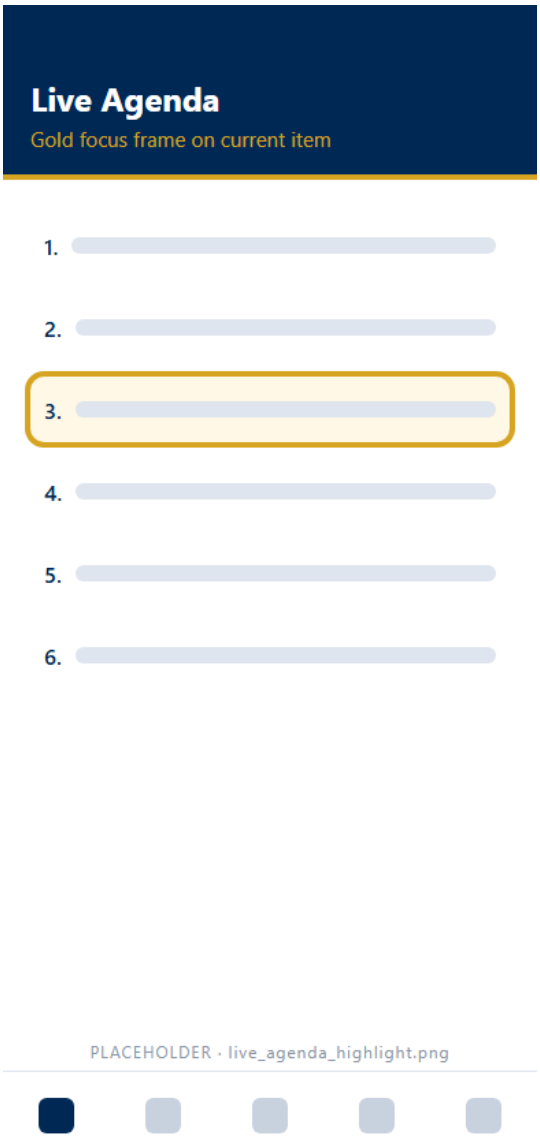
> **Who can do this:** any active member of the council.

Goal: See which agenda line is on the floor now.

Start point: Phone app → **Mtgs** tab.

Steps:

1. Find the meeting card with the live mark.
2. Tap ● **Follow the live agenda**. The **Agenda** sub-tab opens.
3. Check for the red ● **LIVE** tag in the navy header.
4. Read the gold **NOW ON THE FLOOR** banner. The banner shows the item name and the time left.
5. Scroll to the navy section heading.
6. Find the gold line with the **ON THE FLOOR** tag.
7. Keep the screen open. The gold highlight moves when the Grand Knight moves to the next line.



Phone: live agenda with the gold frame on the current line (placeholder)

Expected result: The gold highlight stays on the line under discussion. The countdown in the banner goes down each second.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
"The meeting is live. The line on the floor will be framed as the Grand Knight takes each item."	The Grand Knight has not put a line on the floor yet.	Wait. The highlight shows when the first item starts.
The highlight does not move.	The phone lost its connection.	Check your data or Wi-Fi connection.
No gold shows in Large Text Layout Mode.	Large text mode uses black inside a white frame.	Look for the thick white frame.

5.4 Read meetings in the web portal

> **Who can do this:** any member.

Goal: Read a meeting's details, agenda and minutes.

Start point: Sidebar → Governance → **Meeting Center**.

Steps:

1. Select the meeting in the list.
2. Read the agenda and the minutes link.

Expected result: The meeting details open on the right side.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
No **Edit** controls show.	Only officers, Admins and the meeting owner change a meeting.	Ask an officer.

Concept: check in with the meeting PIN

You check in to a live council meeting from the phone. Checking in marks you present. Only members who checked in may vote on a secret ballot.

- The Recorder (or, when the Recorder is absent, the Grand Knight) reads out a 4-digit meeting PIN at the meeting.
- You type the PIN in the **CHECK IN** box on the phone.
- The phone does not ask for your location.
- After 5 wrong PINs, the PIN box locks for that meeting. An officer can then check you in from the console.
- The Grand Knight sets the PIN. The PIN is not shown to members in the app.

Concept: the annual roadmap

Each spring, the council prepares its next fraternal year in three steps:

Step	Window	Who records the step
Nominations	May 1 to May 31	Any active member nominates; the council records each nomination.
Elections	June 1 to June 30	The council records the elected officers.
Budget Lock	July 1 to July 10	The council approves the next year's budget.

The officers follow these steps on the **Annual Fraternal Roadmap** of the **Executive Dashboard**. When a step passes its due date with nothing recorded, the council's leaders get a push alert. Members do not see the roadmap.

5.5 Check in to a live meeting

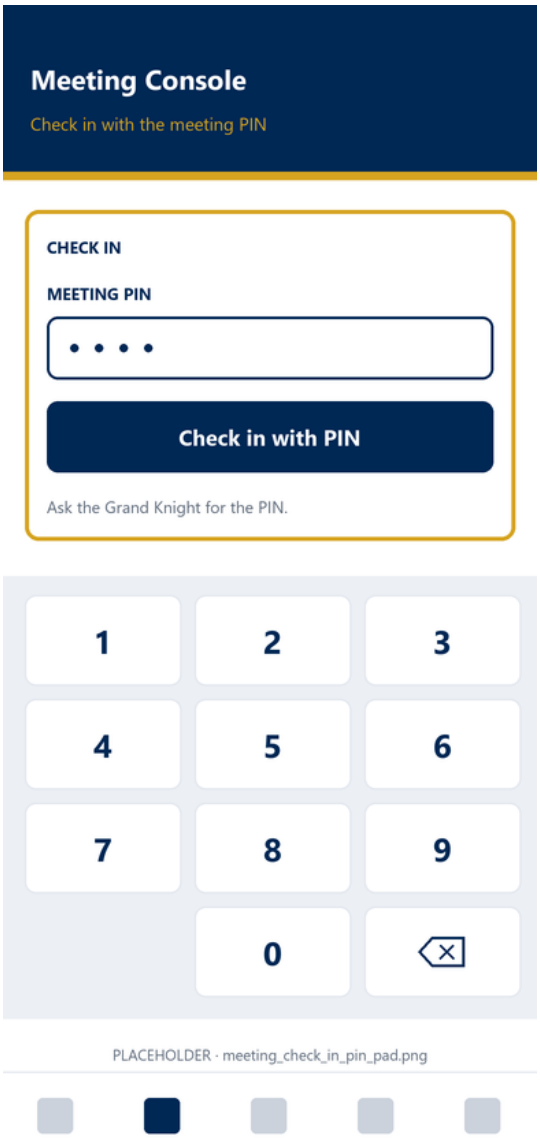
> **Who can do this:** any active member of the meeting's council.

Goal: Mark yourself present at the council meeting, so you may vote.

Start point: Phone app → **Mtgs** tab → ● **Follow the live agenda**.

Steps:

1. Check for the red ● **LIVE** tag in the navy header. The **CHECK IN** box shows only while the meeting is live.
2. Listen for the meeting PIN. The Grand Knight reads out the PIN.
3. Type the 4 digits in **MEETING PIN**.
4. Tap **Check in with PIN**.



Phone: the CHECK IN box with the MEETING PIN field and number pad (placeholder)

Expected result: The box turns navy and shows ✓ **You are checked in**. A message says *"Checked in with the meeting PIN."*

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
Check in with PIN stays grey.	The PIN has fewer than 4 digits.	Type all 4 digits.
"That meeting PIN is not correct. Ask the Grand Knight for the PIN and try again."	The PIN is wrong.	Ask the Grand Knight for the PIN. Type the PIN again.
"You entered a wrong meeting PIN 5 times, so PIN check-in is locked for this meeting. …"	You typed a wrong PIN 5 times.	Ask an officer to check you in from the **Live Meeting Console**.
No **CHECK IN** box.	The meeting is not live yet.	Wait for the Grand Knight to start the meeting.

5.6 Add your photo from the meeting

> **Who can do this:** any member who checked in to the live meeting.

Goal: Keep one photo from the meeting with your check-in.

Start point: Phone app → **Mtgs** tab → ● **Follow the live agenda** → the ✓ **You are checked in** box.

Steps:

1. Tap **Add a meeting photo**.
2. If the phone asks for the camera, tap **Allow**.
3. Take the photo.
4. Confirm the photo in the camera screen.

Expected result: The photo shows in the ✓ **You are checked in** box. To change the photo, tap **Replace my meeting photo**.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
"Camera access is turned off for KofC Tracker. Allow it in your phone settings, then try again."	You did not allow the camera.	Allow the camera in your phone settings.
The photo is not in the web portal.	The phone keeps your photo on the phone.	Send the photo to an Admin. An Admin files meeting photos in the council's Google Drive.

5.7 Cast a secret ballot in the Council Election Center

> **Who can do this:** any active member of the council who is in the meeting room.

Goal: Vote by secret ballot on a motion at a live meeting.

Start point: Web portal on your phone or computer → Sidebar → Governance → **Council Election Center** → 🗳 **Cast Active Ballot**.

Steps:

1. Select 🗳 **Cast Active Ballot** to open the drawer.
2. Listen for the meeting PIN. The chair reads out the PIN.
3. Type the 4 digits in **Enter the meeting PIN**.
4. Select 🔓 **Unlock Ballot**. This checks you in to the meeting.
5. Wait for the chair to open the ballot. The motion shows in the drawer.
6. Select **Approve**, **Deny** or **Abstain**.

Expected result: The drawer shows *"Your secret ballot is cast. It is counted without your name."* The motion shows 🔒 **Your ballot on this motion is recorded.**

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
"No council meeting is in session."	The meeting is not live yet.	Wait for the chair to start the meeting. Select **Check again**.
🔓 **Unlock Ballot** stays grey.	The PIN has fewer than 4 digits.	Type all 4 digits.
"No ballot is open right now."	The chair has not opened the ballot.	Keep the drawer open. The ballot shows when the chair opens it.
You cannot vote again.	You can vote one time on each motion.	No action. Your first ballot counts.

6. File expenses and check status tags

Before you start

- **Access:** any active member files a report. Each member sees only the member's own reports.
- **Data loss:** after **Submit for approval**, you cannot change the report. Only a return from leadership reopens the report.
- **Data loss:** a return clears both officer signatures. The report starts the approval path again.

Concept: the expense path

You buy something for the council. You file an expense report with the receipts. Two officers sign the report. Then the council pays you by check.

Status tag	Meaning
Draft	You saved the report. You did not submit the report.
Submitted	The report waits for the Financial Secretary.
RECORDED BY FS	The Financial Secretary signed a payment request. The report waits for the Treasurer.
CODED BY TREASURER	The Treasurer coded the report to a budget line. The report waits for the Grand Knight.
Approved	The Grand Knight signed. The report waits for payment.
Reimbursed	The Financial Secretary or the Treasurer recorded your check.
Returned (red)	Leadership sent the report back. The reason shows on the report.

The platform sends no email or text about expense reports. Check the status tag.

Concept: the submission window

A report for an event or a meeting has a submission window. The window opens on the first day of the event or meeting. The window closes 30 days after the last day, by default. Your council can change the 30 days. You may save a draft at any time. A **General** report has no window.

6.1 File an expense report on the phone

Who can do this: any active member.

Warning: after **Submit for approval**, you cannot change the report.

Goal: Ask the council to pay you back.

Start point: Phone app → **Home** → **Expense reports** → **My expense reports**.

Steps:

1. Tap **New expense report**.
2. Under **SPENT FOR**, tap **Event**, **Meeting** or **General**.
3. For an event or a meeting, choose the item in **WHICH EVENT?** or **WHICH MEETING?**. The list shows only open windows.
4. Tap **Scan Paper Receipt**. Photograph the receipt.
5. Enter **VENDOR NAME**, **EXPENSE DATE (YYYY-MM-DD)**, **AMOUNT** and **DESCRIPTION**.
6. If the receipt also has your own items, turn on **Split this receipt (Contains personal items)**. Type the part the council pays back in **Requested Reimbursement Amount**.
7. Tap **+ Add another receipt** for each extra receipt.

8. Check the total under **COUNCIL REIMBURSES**. A split receipt counts only the **Requested Reimbursement Amount**.
9. Tap **Submit for approval**. You cannot change the report after this. Tap **Save draft** to finish later.

Expected result: The report shows in **My reports** with the **SUBMITTED** tag.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
"Locked. Submission opens …"	The event or meeting has not started.	Save a draft. Submit on or after the first day.
"Locked. Submission closed …"	More than 30 days (or your council's number) have passed since the end.	Contact the Financial Secretary.
The event is not in the list.	The window is closed or not open yet.	Use **General** only if the cost has no event or meeting.
"Receipt 1 is split: enter the Requested Reimbursement Amount …"	The split switch is on, and the amount box is empty.	Type the amount. Type `0.00` if none of the receipt is for the council.
"… must be a dollar amount from 0.00 up to the receipt's …"	The requested amount is more than the receipt.	Type an amount that is not more than **AMOUNT**.

A split receipt saves as two lines: one council line for the requested amount, and one personal line for the rest. The council pays only the council line.

6.2 File an expense report in the web portal

> **Who can do this:** any active member.
>
> **Warning:** after **Submit for approval**, you cannot change the report.

Goal: File an expense report from a computer.

Start point: Sidebar → Finances → **My Expense Reports**.

Steps:

1. Select **New expense report**.
2. Choose the event, the meeting or **General council expense (no event or meeting)** in **Spent for**.
3. Fill in one line for each receipt. Select **+ Add line item** for more lines.
4. Attach the receipt file to each line.
5. Select **Submit for approval**. You cannot change the report after this. Select **Save draft** to finish later.

Expected result: A message shows *"Submitted report #n for $x to your council's leadership."*

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The submit is refused.	The submission window is closed or not open.	Save a draft. Check the dates of the event or meeting.

6.3 Check the status of an expense report

> **Who can do this:** the member who filed the report.

Goal: Learn where your report is in the approval path.

Start point: Phone app → **Home** → **My expense reports** → **My reports**. Web portal → Finances → **My Expense Reports**.

Steps:

1. Find the report by its number and total.
2. Read the status tag. Compare the tag with the table in the concept above.
3. For a **Reimbursed** report, read the check number and the date.

Expected result: The tag shows the current step. A paid report shows *"Paid by check n on date."*

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The **Home** tab shows *"n of your expense reports was returned for changes."*	Leadership returned a report.	Fix the report (6.4).

6.4 Fix and resubmit a returned report

> **Who can do this:** the member who filed the report.
>
> **Warning:** a return clears both officer signatures. The report starts the approval path again.

Goal: Correct a returned report.

Start point: Phone app → **My expense reports** → the report with **RETURNED**. Web portal → Finances → **My Expense Reports**.

Steps:

1. Read the reason under **RETURNED FOR CHANGES** (phone) or **Reason from council leadership** (web).
2. Tap **Fix and resubmit** (phone), or open the report (web).
3. Correct the receipts or the amounts.
4. Select **Submit for approval**.

Expected result: The tag changes to **SUBMITTED**.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The submit is refused.	The 30-day window closed.	Contact the Financial Secretary.

7. Take donations at an event

Before you start

- **Access:** any active member. The **Collect** tab shows only when your council keeps the **Fundraising inflow** module on.

- **Data loss: Record donation** and each gate-intake tap add a gift to the council's records at once.

- **Data loss:** you cannot delete a donation on the phone. Only the Treasurer, the Financial Secretary or an Admin corrects a donation.

Concept: event sessions and methods

The **Collect** tab links donations to an event. You start a session for the event. Every donation then goes to that event. A donation without a session is a standalone donation.

Tile hint	Methods	What happens
Record the amount	Cash, and other methods your council adds	You enter the amount.
Record the charge	Credit Card	You enter the charged amount.
Show the QR code	Venmo, Zelle, Zeffy, ParishSoft	A full-screen code opens for the donor.
Describe and value	Physical items	You describe the items and estimate the value.

7.1 Start a donation session for an event

Who can do this: any active member of a council linked to the event.

Goal: Link the next donations to one event.

Start point: Phone app → **Collect** tab.

The **Start accepting donations** card is the phone's setup drawer. The phone chooses nothing for you. No event and no donation type is selected when the card opens. You choose each one yourself.

Steps:

1. Tap **Start collecting for event**.
2. Choose the event in **EVENT**.
3. Choose the type in **DONATION TYPE**, for example **Parking**.
4. Optional: type the standard rate in **STANDARD RATE (OPTIONAL)**, for example `25.00` for the parking rate.
5. Optional: fill in **EVENT DESCRIPTION (OPTIONAL)**.
6. Tap **Start**.

Expected result: A gold **ACCEPTING DONATIONS** card shows the event, the count and the total. The **Session setup** line shows the rate and the type you chose.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The event is not in the list.	The list shows an event from 2 hours before the first shift (by default; your council sets the time) until midnight after the event ends.	Wait for the event start. Record a later gift as standalone.
"Choose the event you are collecting for." or *"Choose the donation type."*	You tapped **Start** before you chose the event or the type.	Choose both, then tap **Start**.

7.2 Record a donation

> **Who can do this:** any active member.
>
> **Warning: Record donation** adds the gift to the council's records at once.

Goal: Record one donor's gift.

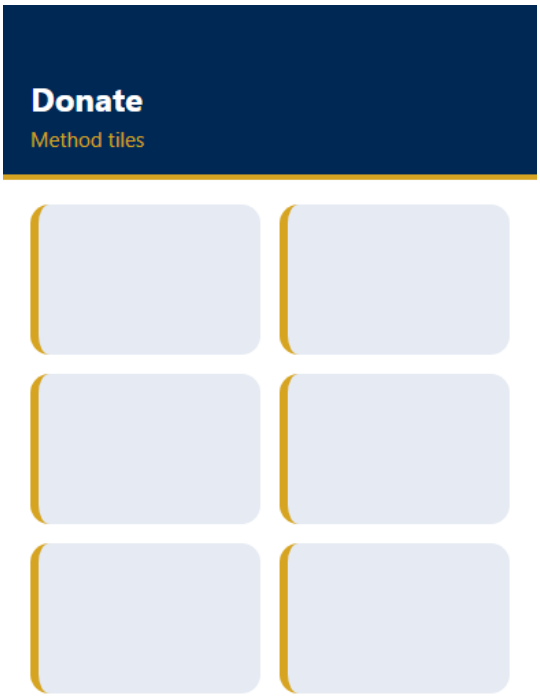
Start point: Phone app → **Collect** → **How is the donor giving?**

The phone does not pick a method. You tap the method. If you typed a standard rate when you started the session, **AMOUNT** already shows that rate. Change it only if the donor gave a different amount.

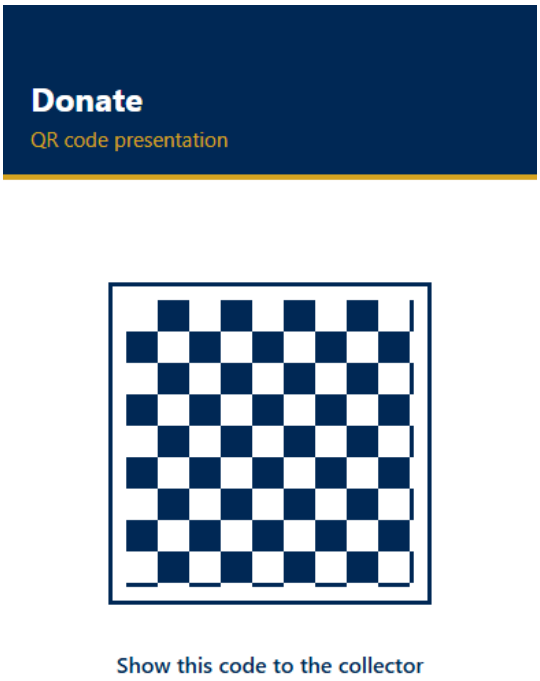
Steps:

1. Tap the tile for the donor's method, for example **Venmo**.
2. For a QR method: read the **Pays into …** line under the heading. Tell the donor whose account receives the gift. Turn the phone to the donor. Wait for the donor's payment confirmation.
3. For a QR method: check the amount. Tap **Continue**.
4. Check the amount in **AMOUNT**. It shows the session's standard rate, for example `25.00`. If the box is empty or the donor gave a different amount, type the amount.
5. Choose the **DONATION TYPE**.
6. Optional: fill in **DONOR NAME (OPTIONAL)** and **DESCRIPTION (OPTIONAL)**.
7. Tap **Record donation**. The gift saves at once.

ParishSoft	Venmo	Zeffy	Zelle
			



Donate Method Tiles (placeholder)



QR Code Presentation (placeholder)

Expected result: A message confirms the amount, the method and the event. **Recorded for this event** lists the donations from every phone.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
"Your council has not uploaded this QR code yet."	A custom QR method has no image.	Take the gift as cash or card. Tell your council Admin.
"The QR code could not be loaded."	The phone is offline, or the image link is broken.	Take the gift as cash or card.
The **Pays into …** line names the wrong account.	The council has not set the account name or owner of the method.	Tell your council Admin or the Treasurer.
"Your council has not enabled any donation methods yet."	The council has no methods.	Ask an Admin, the Treasurer or the Financial Secretary.

7.2.1 Record a donation by check

> **Who can do this:** any active member, when the council turned on the **Check** method.
>
> **Warning: Record donation** adds the gift to the council's records at once.

Goal: Record a gift by paper check, with the number printed on the check.

Start point: Phone app → **Collect** → **How is the donor giving?**

Steps:

1. Tap the **Check** tile.
2. Enter the amount of the check.
3. Enter the number printed on the check in **CHECK NUMBER (REQUIRED)**.
4. Choose the **DONATION TYPE**.
5. Optional: fill in **DONOR NAME (OPTIONAL)**.
6. Optional: under **DEPOSIT PHOTO (OPTIONAL)**, tap 📷 **Attach Deposit Photo**. Photograph the front of the check. The Cash form has no photo button.
7. Tap **Record donation**. The gift saves at once.

Expected result: A message says *"Recorded $50.00 by Check for … Thank the donor!"* with the amount and the event. With a photo, the message also says *"Deposit photo attached."*. In a room pilot, the photo is kept on the hub laptop.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
"Enter the check number printed on the check."	**CHECK NUMBER (REQUIRED)** is empty.	Enter the check number. Tap **Record donation** again.
There is no **Check** tile.	The council did not turn on the Check method.	Take the gift as cash. Tell your council Admin.
"The deposit photo was not attached: …"	The gift saved, but the photo did not.	Tell the Financial Secretary. The gift does not need the photo.
The phone asks for camera access.	The app needs your permission to use the camera.	Tap **Allow**. Or turn on camera access for the app in the phone settings.

7.3 Record a physical item donation

> **Who can do this:** any active member.
>
> **Warning: Record donation** adds the items to the council's records at once.

Goal: Record donated goods.

Start point: Phone app → **Collect** → **Physical items** tile.

Steps:

1. Describe the items in **WHAT WAS DONATED**. The field is required.
2. Enter the estimated value.
3. Optional: tap **Take Verification Photo**.
4. Tap **Record donation**.

Expected result: The item donation is saved. Item values do not count toward the event's cash or electronic funds.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The save is refused.	**WHAT WAS DONATED** is empty.	Describe the items.

7.4 Record gate gifts right after Start

> **Who can do this:** any active member of a council linked to the event.
>
> **Warning: Record donation** adds the gift to the council's records at once.

Goal: Record the cars at the gate one after another, with no extra switch.

Start point: Phone app → **Collect** → the **ACCEPTING DONATIONS** card.

Steps:

1. Tap **Start** on the setup card. The payment tiles under **How is the donor giving?** open at once. There is no second switch.
2. Tap the donor's tile, for example **Cash** or **Venmo**. **AMOUNT** shows your standard rate.
3. Tap **Record donation**.
4. Read the confirmation at the top of the screen. The screen scrolls back to the top by itself, with the tiles ready for the next donor.

Expected result: Each **Record donation** adds one donation to the event, and the screen is ready for the next car.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
"Cash is not enabled"	The council has no Cash method.	Ask your council Admin to enable Cash.
The 🎬 **Start Active Intake Session** switch is gone.	The tiles now open as soon as you tap **Start**.	Use the tiles.
You recorded one gift too many.	Each **Record donation** saves a donation.	Ask the Treasurer, the Financial Secretary or an Admin to correct the donation.

7.4.1 Record a cash box drop

> **Who can do this:** any active member of a council linked to the event.
>
> **Warning: Record donation** adds the cash total to the council's records at once.

Goal: Record the cash box of a shift as one consolidated donation.

Start point: Phone app → **Collect** → the **ACCEPTING DONATIONS** card.

Steps:

1. Count the cash in the cash box.
2. Under **How is the donor giving?** tap **Cash**.
3. Type the total in **AMOUNT**, for example `180.00`.
4. Type a note in **DESCRIPTION (OPTIONAL)**, for example `Cash box drop - Saturday lot`.
5. Tap **Record donation**.

Expected result: One cash donation with the full total shows under **Recorded for this event**.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The cash shows twice.	A member also recorded each car's cash one at a time.	Ask the Financial Secretary to correct the donations. Record either single gifts or one drop, not both.

7.5 Stop the donation session

> **Who can do this:** the member who started the session on this phone.

Goal: End the event link on this phone.

Start point: Phone app → **Collect** → the **ACCEPTING DONATIONS** card.

Steps:

1. Tap **Stop accepting – the event is over**.

Expected result: New donations are standalone again.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
A donation went to the wrong event.	The session was still on.	Ask the Treasurer, the Financial Secretary or an Admin to correct the donation.

8. Propose a charity grant

Before you start

- **Access:** any active member. The page shows only when your council keeps the **Charity proposals** module on.
- **Access:** you cannot vet your own request. Another officer or a Trustee vets the request.
- **Data loss:** none. A filed request stays in **My requests**.

Concept: the Knight Shepherd

Any member can bring an organization's request to the council. The member who files the request is the Knight Shepherd. The request moves through three steps: **Vetting**, **Presentation** at a council meeting, and **Payment Made** by check. The Trustees ask the Shepherd for a status report 6 months after the filing date.

Concept: verified charities fill in the form

An Admin verifies trusted charities in the **Global Charities Registry**. The form lists only verified charities in its **Organization** list. When you select a verified charity, the form fills in the name, mission, mailing address, Employer Identification Number (EIN) and contact details. For an organization that is not on the list, select **Another organization (type it in)** and type the details.

8.1 File a charity grant request

Who can do this: any active member.

Warning: you cannot vet your own request. Another officer or a Trustee vets the request.

Goal: Ask the council to fund an organization.

Start point: Sidebar → Finances → **Propose Charity Grant**.

Steps:

1. In **Organization / Ministry**, select the organization's **State**.
2. Select the organization in **Organization**. The form fills in the name, mission, address, EIN and contact details.
3. Check the filled-in details. Change any detail that is out of date.
4. If the organization is not in the list, select **Another organization (type it in)**. Type the name, mission and mailing address.
5. Fill in **Contact Details** if the form did not fill them in.
6. Fill in **The Request**: the amount, the date and the specific use.
7. Select **Save and submit for vetting**.

Expected result: A tracking message names the three steps and the follow-up date. The request shows in **My requests**.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The request stops at one step.	Vetting declined the request, or the council voted no.	Read the step in **My requests**.
The **State** list shows **No verified charities yet**.	No Admin has verified a charity yet.	Select **Another organization (type it in)** after you choose a state, or ask an Admin to verify the charity.
The organization is not in the **Organization** list.	The charity is not verified, or it is in another state.	Select **Another organization (type it in)** and type the details.

9. Messages, roster, profile and display

Before you start

- **Access:** any member. You change only your own profile, your own lists and your own display setting.
- **Data loss:** a reply goes to everyone in the thread. You cannot take back a sent reply.
- **Data loss:** a new email address also changes your sign-in name.

9.1 Read and reply to messages

Who can do this: any member.

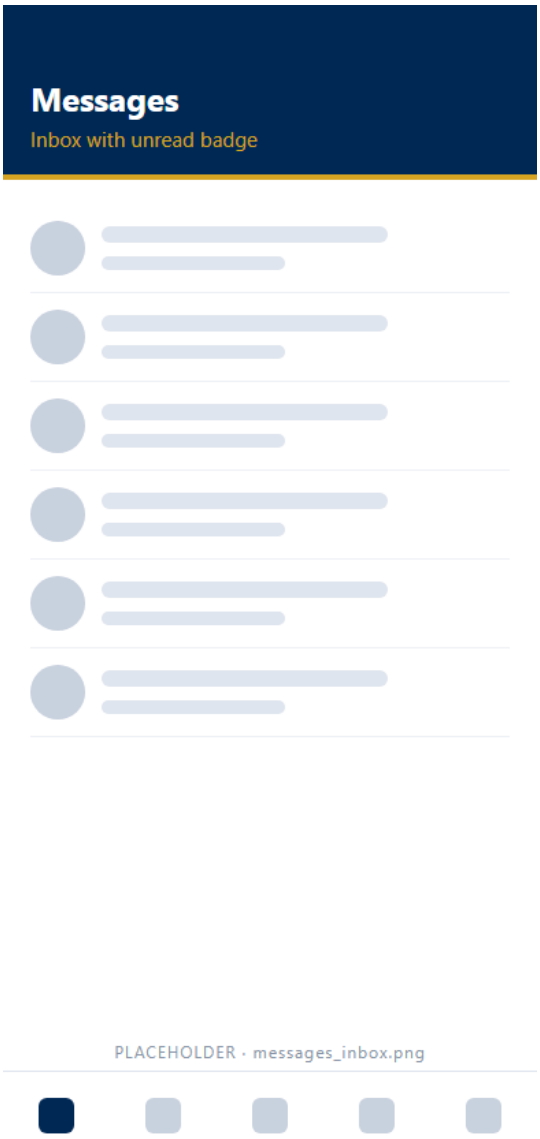
Warning: a reply goes to everyone in the thread.

Goal: Read council messages and answer them.

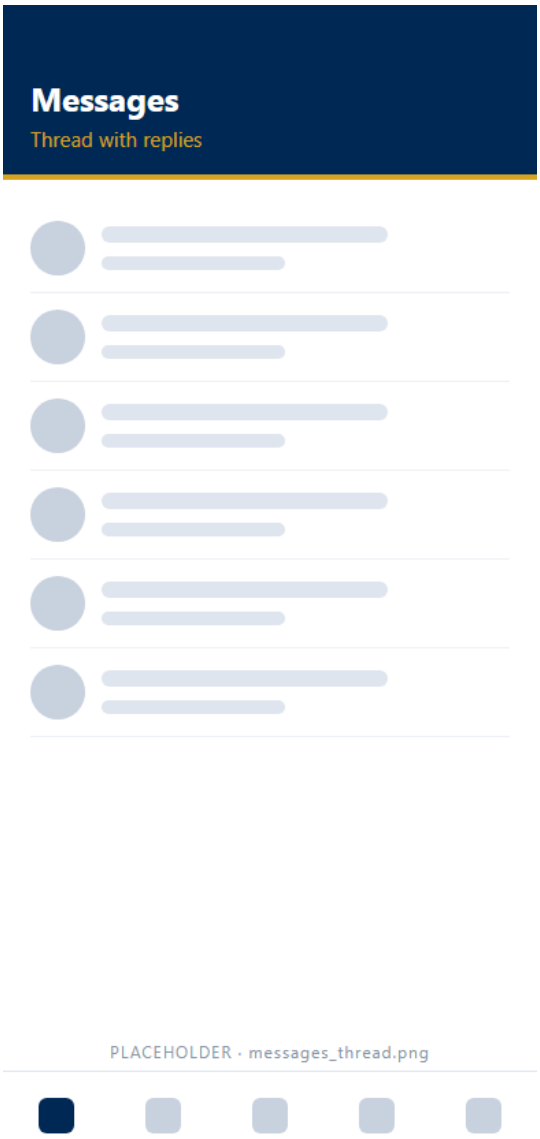
Start point: Phone app → envelope in the header → **Messages**. Web portal → **Messaging** → **Council Messages & Alerts**.

Steps:

1. Select a message to open the thread.
2. Read the replies in order.
3. Write your reply.
4. Send the reply. Everyone in the thread gets the reply.



Phone: Messages inbox with unread badge (placeholder)



Phone: message thread with replies (placeholder)

Expected result: The reply shows in the thread. On the phone, a **Replying to** line names the earlier message.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
An attachment does not open on the phone.	The phone app has no attachment preview.	Open the message in the web portal.

9.2 Build a private distribution list

> **Who can do this:** any member. Only you see your private lists.

Goal: Save a group of members for repeat messages.

Start point: Web portal → **Messaging** → **My Distribution Lists**.

Steps:

1. Enter a name in **List name**.
2. Pick members in **Members**. The picker searches by name.

3. Save the list.

Expected result: The list shows under your lists. Council-wide lists from Admins show there too, read only.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
You cannot change a council-wide list.	Only Admins change council-wide lists.	Ask your council Admin.

9.3 Find a Brother Knight's phone or email

> **Who can do this:** any member.

Goal: Contact another member.

Start point: Sidebar → Faith In Action → **[Council Roster]**. The same list is on the **Member Desk** tab and on the **Fraternal roster** tab of the **Member Actions Hub**.

Steps:

1. Enter a name or a member number in **Search by name or number**.
2. Read the phone and the email in the row.

Expected result: The roster shows active members of your council and its sister councils.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
A member is missing.	The member is not active.	Ask your council Admin.

9.4 Update your profile

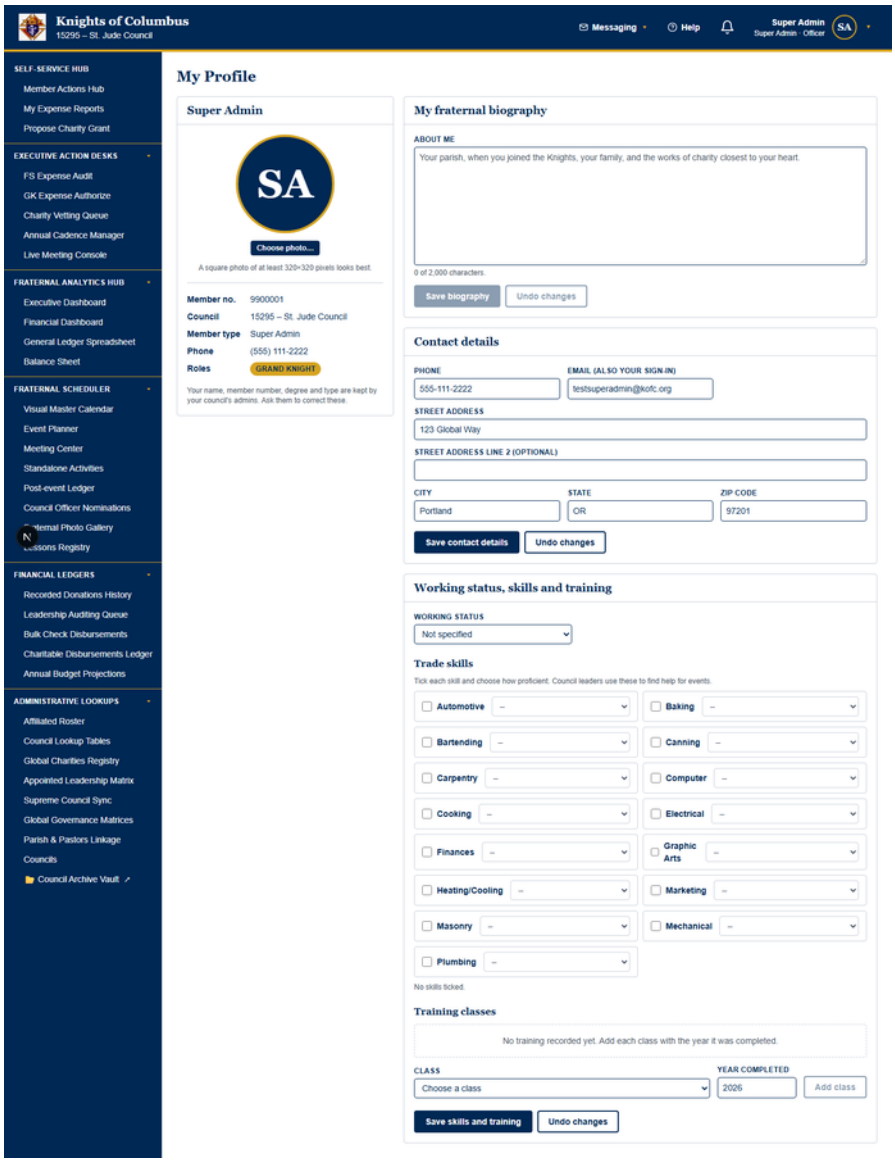
> **Who can do this:** any member, on the member's own profile.
>
> **Warning:** a new email address also changes your sign-in name.

Goal: Keep your photo, contact details and skills current.

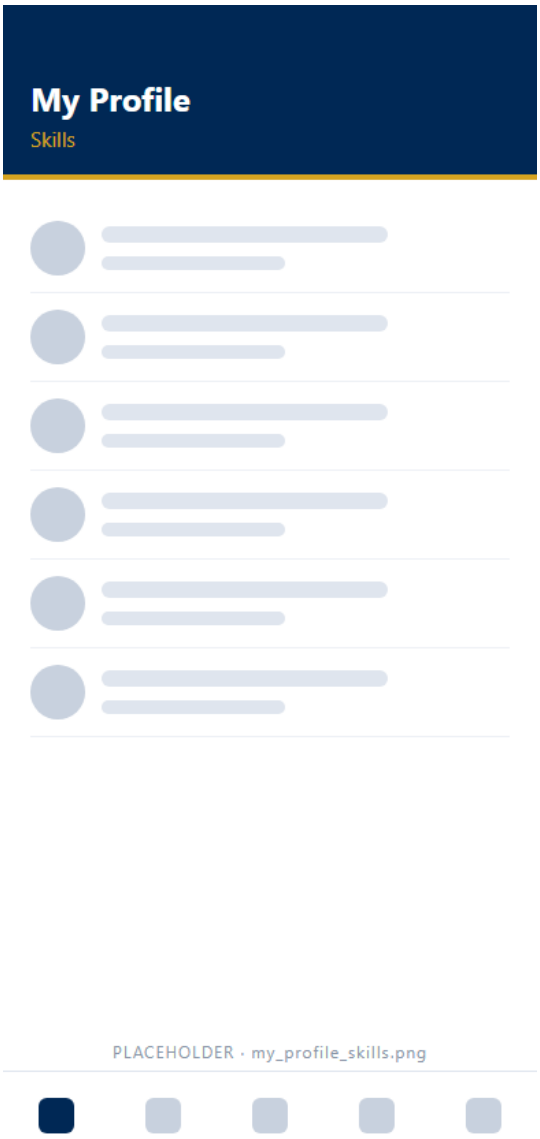
Start point: Web portal → your name at the top right → **My Profile**.

Steps:

1. Select **Choose photo…** to add a photo. Use a square photo of at least 320 × 320 pixels.
2. Write up to 2,000 characters in **My fraternal biography**. Select **Save biography**.
3. Change your phone, email or address in **Contact details**. A new email is your new sign-in name.
4. Select **Save contact details**.
5. Add your trade skills in **Working status, skills and training**.



My Profile in the portal (/profile)



My Profile Skills (placeholder)

Expected result: The header shows your new photo. Admins can find you by skill.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
You cannot change your name, member number or degree.	Council Admins keep these fields.	Ask your council Admin.

9.5 Turn on Large Text Layout Mode

> **Who can do this:** any member, on the member's own account.

Goal: Make the phone app easier to read.

Start point: Phone app → your name in the header → **Settings** → **Display**. Web portal → **My Profile** → **Display settings**.

Steps:

1. Turn on **[👓 Enable Large Text Layout Mode]**.

Expected result: The phone app shows larger bold white text on black, with gold borders and taller buttons. The activity tiles fill the screen width, one tile per row. The web portal stores the setting only. The web portal does not change size.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The header shows no title or **Sign out**.	Large text mode hides the header text.	Tap ⚙ **Settings** to sign out or to turn the mode off.

9.6 Report a problem or share an idea

> **Who can do this:** any member.

Goal: Tell your council's Admin about a problem or an idea.

Start point: Header → **Messaging** → the Communications Hub.

Steps:

1. Start a message to your council's Admin.
2. Describe the screen you were on, what you did and what you expected.
3. Send the message.

Expected result: Your council's Admin gets the message. The Admin sends the note on to the platform owner from **Administrative Feedback Loops** when needed.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The Online Help Center has no feedback form.	Since Sprint 8O, only council Admins send notes to the platform owner.	Message your council's Admin.

9.7 Open the Council Dashboard

> **Who can do this:** any active member.

Goal: See how the council is doing this month and your own service record.

Start point: Phone app → **Home** → **Open the Council Dashboard**. Web portal: Sidebar → Performance → **Council Dashboard**.

Steps:

1. Open the start point.
2. Read **This month**: the number of volunteers, their hours and their names.
3. Read **Our combined devotions**: the council's totals. No member's own count shows.
4. Read **Leaderboard**: the Top 5 volunteers with the most hours.
5. Read **My impact**: your events, your hours, your merit tier and your council history. The merit tier counts this fraternal year only. It starts again every July 1.

Expected result: The **Council Dashboard** shows the council's service and your own impact. The page shows no money.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
Your hours are lower than you expect.	Some hours wait for leadership review.	Wait for a leader to approve the hours. Then open the page again.
My impact shows no council history.	The council did not record your earlier councils.	Tell your council Admin.

9.8 Read the council newsletters

> **Who can do this:** any signed-in member of the council.

Goal: Read the newest newsletters from your Council Historian.

Start point: Web portal → **Home** (the portal opens there after you sign in).

Steps:

1. Open **Home**. The **[📰 Latest Council Newsletters & Bulletins]** card is at the top of the page.
2. Read the newest newsletter. It shows in full.
3. To read an older newsletter, select its headline.

Expected result: The newsletter shows its headline, its month and its text, with paragraphs, section headings and bullets.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The card does not show.	The council has no saved newsletter yet.	No action. The card shows when the Council Historian saves a newsletter.
You look for the card on the phone.	The newsletter card is in the web portal only.	Open the web portal.

Concept: the phone prayer and devotion drawers

The phone **Home** tab keeps the first screen short. Two drawers sit under the greeting. Both drawers are closed when **Home** opens.

Drawer	What the drawer holds	Closed drawer shows
[📿 Active Spiritual Intentions Drawer]	The council's open prayer intentions, **[🙏 Praying Hands]** and the box to post an intention	The number of open intentions
[📖 Daily Devotional Drawer]	Today's Bible verse (NABRE), your devotional tally and your shield	Today's verse reference

The drawers show only when your council uses the Faith Center.

9.9 Open a prayer or devotion drawer on the phone

> **Who can do this:** any member of a council that uses the Faith Center.

Goal: Read the prayer intentions, or log your devotions, from the phone **Home** tab.

Start point: Phone app → **Home** → under the greeting.

Steps:

1. Tap **[📿 Active Spiritual Intentions Drawer]** or **[📖 Daily Devotional Drawer]**. The drawer opens.
2. Use the drawer. For example, tap **[🙏 Praying Hands]** or tap **Log devotions**.
3. Tap the drawer name again to close the drawer.

Expected result: The open drawer shows its list or its form under the drawer name. The arrow at the right points down.

Common problems:

Problem	Cause	Fix
The drawers do not show.	Your council does not use the Faith Center.	Ask your council Admin.
A drawer is closed again after you leave **Home**.	Each drawer closes when **Home** opens again.	Tap the drawer name again.

10. Troubleshooting reference

Message or symptom	Cause	Fix
"We could not find … in the member roster."	Your email is not on the roster.	Tap **Try a different email**, or call the Admin on the card.
"That setup code is not valid for this email …"	The setup code is wrong, used or expired.	Ask your council Admin for a new setup code.
"The two passwords do not match."	The two entries differ.	Type both passwords again.
"Incorrect password. Please try again."	The password is wrong.	Reset the password (2.6).
No biometric button	You set the password on another phone.	Sign in with your password.
A tab is missing on the phone	Your council switched off the module.	Ask your council Admin.
Taps say **QUEUED**	Taps wait for the slide bar. The platform has not saved the taps yet.	Drag **Slide to Log Hours** to the right end (4.2).
The slide circle springs back	You let go too early.	Drag the circle all the way to the right end.
🔒 **Reporting locked** on a shift	The 30-day phone window is closed.	Use the web **Hour ledger** within 90 days.
Hours refused as an invalid step	The value is not a 15-minute step.	Use :00, :15, :30 or :45.
Activity date refused	The date is older than the logging window (90 days by default).	The window is closed. Ask your council Admin.
The gold agenda highlight does not move	The phone lost its connection.	Check your data or Wi-Fi connection.
"Locked. Submission closed …" on an expense	The 30-day expense window is closed.	Contact the Financial Secretary.
QR code missing	The council has no image for the method.	Take cash or card. Tell your council Admin.
Event missing from **Collect**	The event is not at the gate yet.	Wait until 2 hours before the first shift, by default.
"That meeting PIN is not correct. …"	The PIN is wrong.	Ask the Grand Knight for the PIN (5.5).
"Enter the check number printed on the check."	A check donation has no check number.	Enter the number printed on the check (7.2.1).

Still stuck? Open **Answers** → **Online Help Center**. You can also message your council Admin.

11. Automated messages reference

Delivery in this version: the platform prepares emails and texts. The email and text services are not connected yet.

Check the screen in the **Where to check** column. Alerts from officers always show under the bell in the web portal.

Hybrid messaging rule: an email or a text is only a short nudge. The nudge sends you back to the platform.

Conversations stay in **Messages**. Decisions on expenses and grants stay on the status tags and desks.

No dollar amount or private reason goes by email or text.

Charity grant requests

When	What you get	Where to check
You save a request	A tracking message with the three steps and the follow-up date	**Propose Charity Grant → My requests**
6 months after filing	The Trustees ask you for a status report. The app sends no reminder.	The date in your tracking message

Expense reports

The platform sends no message about expense reports. Read the status tag (section 6).

Volunteer service

When	What you get	Where to check
24 hours before your shift	A reminder email with a calendar file	**Home → My Active Shifts**
24 hours before your meeting	A reminder email with a calendar file and the agenda	**Mtgs → My Invites**
5 days after a shift with no hours	A text reminder	**Report** tab, or the web **Hour ledger**
Every 7 days after that	A follow-up text, until the shift is older than the logging window (90 days by default)	Same as above
An officer sends an urgent alert	A phone push alert and a bell entry	The bell in the web portal keeps 6 months of alerts
An Admin adds you to the roster	A welcome email with the app steps and a setup code	Ask your council Admin if the email is missing
You request a password reset	An email with a 6-digit code that expires in 15 minutes	The reset screen (2.6)

Disclaimer

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